

FINAL REPORT

**Twentieth
Annual Meeting
of the
General Service
Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous**

**Hotel New Yorker
New York
April 20-25, 1970**



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An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other group officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s General Services. This report is "confidential" only because in it certain members must be identified by name. The "confidential" designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.

Service—The Heart of A.A.

—CONFERENCE THEME

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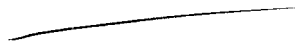


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Conference at a Glance

Growing Need for A.A. Services

Delegates Plan for Future

Policies have been established in recent months which will have lasting importance for our Fellowship, Dr. John L. Norris, Chairman of the Board of Trustees told Delegates to the 20th General Service Conference.

Among these was A.A.'s first World Service Meeting, said Dr. Jack, who is a nonalcoholic trustee and former associate medical director of Eastman Kodak Co. He noted that the meeting had been attended by delegates from twelve foreign countries and one zone who met with our own North American delegates in New York last October "in what must rank as a truly historic service meeting in which your whole board participated."

Dr. Norris said that the board also set qualifications for its first general service trustee-at-large and formed two new trustees committees. The first of these will be a long-range planning committee charged with responsibility for anticipating the fellowship's future.

The second committee will be responsible for working with alcoholism agencies, he said, noting that it will suggest policies and guidelines to govern our cooperation.

NEW A.A. SIZE

Spring 1970

	Groups	Members
United States	9,047	156,817
Lone Members . . .		157
Canada	1,590	22,661
Lone Members . . .		45
In Hospitals	742	20,160
In Prisons	895	33,871
Internationalists . .		366
	12,274	234,077
Overseas*	3,350	63,000
Totals	15,624	297,077

*Estimated only, until Part II of the *World Directory* is published in August 1970.

(including non-reported members, actual membership is estimated at more than 450,000 worldwide.)

New York, April 25 — Inspired by the theme, **SERVICE: THE HEART OF A.A.**, Delegates to the 20th Annual General Service Conference which ended here today reviewed the past and looked to the future in seeking new and improved ways in which A.A. can extend the hand of hope to alcoholics throughout the world who still suffer.

The ninety delegates, representing groups from every state and province in the United States and Canada, worked through a five and one-half day series of almost continuous meetings and workshops at the New Yorker Hotel during which they discussed ways and means of attracting new members and of maintaining effective cooperation with our friends.

Delegates, together with alcoholic and nonalcoholic General Service Board Trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors and staff members form the 129-member Conference which acts on behalf of the Fellowship to provide guidance to the Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine. Some Conference highlights:

POLICY — Recommended formation of a task force be appointed by Dr. Norris to review procedures and mechanics of the General Service Conference.

TRUSTEES — Recommended that General Service trustees (regional and at large) candidates may be either elected from each Conference area within a state or province, or that two or more areas within a state or province may jointly propose a single candidate if they wish.

PUBLIC INFORMATION — Recommended preparation of a brief statement explaining why A.A. retains the Tradition of anonymity at the public level — for use by members being interviewed by media and also to increase understanding among A.A. members.

G.S. BOARD — Nominated Arthur Miles as non-A.A. trustee and Jim H. as general service trustee at large.

INSTITUTIONS — Recommended that wording concerning definition of A.A.'s position on membership in institutional groups be changed to read: "Open meetings are traditionally open to all interested in A.A., but

should be devoted exclusively to the alcoholic problem." And, "Closed meetings should traditionally be restricted to alcoholics."

GRAPEVINE — Delegates urged, when making their report to their areas, to be sure to include the Grapevine.

FINANCE — Noted that 37% of total number of regular groups in U.S. and Canada do not contribute to cost of General Services and recommended that they be encouraged to participate if only on a token basis. Suggested that this be accomplished through better use of G.S.O. filmstrip, educational program for G.S.R.'s, acknowledgment of G.S.O.'s need for money at annual conferences, extension of Birthday Plan to include groups as well as individuals and sponsorships of gratitude month.

PILLS — Conducted extensive workshop discussion on the combined alcohol and pill problem and pointed up the need for increased sharing with members regarding the dangers of mood-changing drugs. (See Final Conference Report).

WORLD SERVICE MEETING — Approved participation in future meetings, every three years, the next in New York, with expenses on a more equitable basis, if possible. Also agreed to principle of rotation regarding election of delegates to future meetings.

AGENDA-ADMISSIONS — Recommended that moratorium on admission of new delegates to Conference be continued until further guidelines be brought to Conference for review.

A Look at the Twentieth

Our deliberations these past five days have resulted in another long step down the road of service.

It is not for me to tell *you* about service; rather, let me remind you what you have said about service during the course of this Conference.

Theme Defined

First of all, you have defined our theme for us. Thus John M. told us that service is "work done or duty performed for another or others." In A.A., he explained, this means "carrying the message of A.A." And he reminded us too that having "service" as a *theme* is not enough; we must make it a *reality* as well.

Similarly, Gil W. said that service was "the performance of labor for another," and he gave as an example the people who had spent much time with him when he first came into the program—in other words, service, he reminded us, is Twelfth Step work. And Tom O'N. reminded us of the true goal of service—to reach the still suffering alcoholic.

Indeed, service in A.A. has many faces. Some see it in terms of public information. Thus, Jim C. told us that in Western New York, great P.I. strides have been made, in part at least, because P.I. speakers are not only furnished with a P.I. kit but actually are sent to a P.I. "school." And Terry P. told us of a "training session," set up by the area committee, which P.I. speakers must attend.

Margaret C. also spoke about P.I. She told us of the talks by A.A. members to schools and colleges in her area. . . and of the formation of a Young People's Group-On-Campus, a direct result of this P.I. effort. Margaret went on to say that "people *out there* have a God-given right to know, and that each and every one of *us* has a God-given responsibility to reach out to them, wherever they might be."

Tradition Two Vital to Service

Both Paul S. and Bob A., in speaking of service, brought us back to the basic spiritual values inherent in all service work. Paul reminded us that "we have but one authority in A.A. and that one is a loving God." Bob A. also emphasized the *vital* importance of our second Tradition to *any* program of service.

And Alex B. spoke of the spiritual values implicit in our recovery, which, said Alex, "we in A.A. regard as so important."

And lest we forget the many services rendered by others, Clarence B. stressed the important part played by Al-Anon in helping to stage service meetings out in Minnesota.

Many of you spoke of service in terms of institutional work—and surely no better example of service could be found. Thus Bud W. pointed out to us the great need for sponsorship of inmate members upon release. Roy C. emphasized this same point when he said that Vermont A.A.'s feel that "this is service in the true A.A. tradition." Jimmy D. also spoke of progress in this same area in New Mexico.

Chuck L., too, saw service exemplified by the institutional work in his area. And he thanked *us* for the "opportunity to

share." If service is the heart of A.A., then perhaps, as Chuck suggests, *sharing* is the heart of service.

And Lum S. told us of the fine service program set up by the Institutions and Agencies Committee of the Delaware state assembly.

Floyd D. spoke of a special need. He noted that in a number of institutions Al-Anon literature and speakers are also greatly needed—surely a challenge for many other areas.

Herman F. explained service in Wyoming in terms of dedication. "We have some real dedicated guys and gals," Herman told us, in spite of being "large in miles and low in numbers."

Rollie C. brought us back to a basic consideration—we should all "thank God for being alive," said Rollie, "that we may render A.A. service." And Ralph F. left us a clearly defined goal—"Service without sovereignty." To achieve this goal, Ralph points out, we have as a guide our literature, the mottoes and our rich history of shared experience, strength and hope. In this way, said Ralph, "the path may be wide and smooth and available to all for as long as it is needed."

A.A. Urged not to Dilute its Efforts

In his fine talk, Dr. Jack clarified the whole broad problem of pills for us, while Dr. Dancy reminded us that the combined use of alcohol and other drugs is far from a new problem; it has been with us from the very beginnings of A.A.! And Dr. Dole gave us some wonderful advice when he urged us not to *dilute* our efforts.

Ted C. too, spoke about alcohol and pills. And he brought us back to a basic consideration when he quoted an oldtime Ohio A.A. who asked "Are we doing all we can with what we have today?" Surely this is a question we might *all* profitably ask ourselves. On this same subject, Betty H. gave us good advice when she reminded us that when we carry the message to the medical profession, we should do so *not* as "authorities on alcoholism, but as *victims* of it." Excellent advice indeed!

George B. talked of service in terms of area structure; reminding us all that a strong structure is essential in strengthening service. Carl F. spoke of structure, too, and of area activities. He told of their three provincial conference meetings each year, and how helpful they have been in interesting G.S.R.'s.

Another who spoke to us about structure was Ellery S. He described the recent broadening of the service structure out in Southern California, and he told us that from now on the delegate from *his* area can truly feel that he represents *all* the A.A.'s in that Conference area.

Some of you spoke of service as exemplified by special meetings. Ralph W., for instance, described a new service meeting, called the "Information Group," and he told us how helpful this had been in helping to resolve problems in Northern California. Williard F. spoke of his high hopes for the first Maine Round-Up, and Stan B. told us of their success in staging the N.B./P.E.I. Round-Up.

General Service Conference

Doris C. spoke of G.S.R. workshops. She said they are *sharing* sessions, reminding us anew of *service* through *sharing*.

Cecil H. was another who talked of sharing. He spoke for all of us, telling of his gratitude at sharing this Conference with us.

Sam F. emphasized another area of service, when he told about the Court School established in his area. Drunk cases there have been reduced by almost half as a result of this particular service.

Joe F., too, told us of the establishing of a Court program in his area, with the formation of a committee to provide on-call duty to the various judges in the area's several courts. And Bob D., in speaking about institutional work in Mississippi, pointed out that the ex-inmate needs, more than anything else, a few people who really care about him. So that, too, is what sharing is all about—"caring" for others.

Bob R. spoke eloquently of service in terms of *giving*. "Our ultimate goal," said Bob "is to teach all Georgia A.A.'s that in an attitude of love and service, we must give that others may live." Betty V. said it another way when she told us that in Oregon "service—the heart of A.A., is not merely a theme, but a way of life."

Henri C. spoke of service in terms of publishing, reminding us once more that "literature, too, can carry the message." Another who reminded us of literature as a service tool was Al D., who offered us some excellent suggestions for improving our *literature service*.

The Need to Keep Informed

Art K. spoke of the need for keeping informed. "Our lines of communication," Art told us, "are strengthened in proportion to our awareness." And he pointed out that the stronger our lines of communication, the better informed we become. Luke B. also spoke of service through communications. "Communications," said Luke, "between committees, G.S.R.'s and groups seem to be the key to service success."

Bill W. told us about the way in which their key service people improve communications. Whenever one of them, said Bill, writes to another about any service matter, he sends copies of his letter to all the others. A most useful idea, I think, and one which some of you may wish to try.

Fred S. told us something of his, and the Florida Host Committee's Convention activities. But if Fred had talked for four hours he couldn't have really covered all the work that he and they have done to prepare for this great meeting. Assuredly, this, too, is service work of inestimable value.

We were reminded by Bob Wilson of one aspect of service work which too many A.A.'s overlook—it costs *money* to provide service. Bob pointed out that in order to operate successfully at *any* level of A.A. activity, two things are required. One, help and guidance of a loving God and two, the dollar bills of the alcoholics who are sober—but still tight!

Several of you spoke of service in terms of special groups. Arnold J. spoke about the forming of groups on the Indian

reservations in North Dakota. Ray R., too, told us that in Montana, work with Indians has grown tremendously.

Carrying Our Message to Young People

Both Helen S. and Mike H. spoke of young people's groups being started in their areas. Surely there can be no greater service than "carrying the message" to the new generation.

John O'K. brought out an important point when he told us that down in Maryland groups all over the state are beginning to understand service and the concept of A.A. as a *whole fellowship*. And Edith S. recalled for us the *personal* rewards of serving others. "Among these rewards," said Edith, "are personal peace of mind and compassion for others."

Hal C. reminded us of another obligation: how well he said it! "Our principal interest," Hal told us, "lies in promoting a sense of *responsibility in service*. Our Fellowship will endure," he went on, "so long as individually and collectively 'we care'." And he concluded his remarks by emphasizing—and again I quote—"the great *personal* rewards which are the automatic end-product of A.A. service."

Zora H. saw service as the third side of our triangle, reminding us again that *service* is our Third Legacy.

Contribution of Past Delegates and G.S.R.'s

In his detailed report on service in S.E. Michigan, Joe C. gave all the credit for progress in his area to the G.S.R.'s and past delegates, thus teaching us all a lesson in humility—a quality, incidentally, bound to enhance *any* A.A. service.

Mary Elizabeth S. spoke to us of growth—and of how growth increased our *capacity* for service. She found our literature a great means of achieving maturity and understanding.

Let me quote just two more of you: Charlie W. said it all for me when he told us "In our area, the heart of A.A. is kept beating by the love and compassion of its members."

Service Is The Heart of A.A.

And, finally, I would like to quote from Eric B.'s keynote talk: "What," Eric asked us, "is service?" Yes, it is a ten-cent cup of coffee, he said. "It is getting up at 2:00 o'clock in the morning to call on a sick alcoholic. It is an area assembly or a General Service Conference. It is the end of a broom. It is a learning and serving—and a living and giving—and a caring and sharing—and that's what it's all about. In this A.A. way of life, we have three great and lasting Legacies: Recovery, Unity, and Service. And the greatest of these is Service, for service encompasses all three—and service is love—and the language of the heart—in action. Service is the heart of A.A."

And now, one final word from me. You—all of you—brought with you from your own areas such a wealth of information, such a dedicated commitment, such gifts of love and understanding that you have truly made this Conference a unique service experience for me. And for this, I am truly grateful.

—Bob H., Vice Chairman
General Service Conference

Service—the Heart of A.A.

"Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of alcoholics in *action*. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die.

"Hence, an A.A. service is *anything whatever* that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer—ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.'s General Service Office for national and international action. The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy."

This is a quotation from our co-founder, Bill W., as he introduces the subject of service in the opening pages of the new "A.A. Service Manual." Service is our Third Legacy. Service is the name of the game. Service is the Heart of A.A.

In order to get everything into a sound perspective, it might be well to go back a few years; not all the way back—but back, say, to our own D-Day. We must consider what happened on that day when we decided to ask for help. We must remember how we felt. The terrible feelings of desperation, guilt, hopelessness and helplessness were about all we had left. All our crutches were gone. We had no place else to go. And *A.A. was there. A.A. was there because somebody had done something.* Somebody had made it possible for us to get the message that there was an answer for us: recovery, unity and service—these three were there long before it was spelled out in such terms, long before the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts for World Service ever took shape. It took a little time before these things got spelled out in words so beautiful. And now you can't separate one from the other two. When we talk about Service: the Heart of A.A., we can't separate because to separate means to take away.

Where Does Service Begin?

But where does service begin? Someone had paid to keep the telephone answering service available until I made my call for help. Someone had made it possible for me to make a contact by letting me know what number to call. And when I made the contact, all of A.A. that had ever existed was there, just waiting for me.

When we first come into the program our responsibilities don't appear to be very great. We present a warm body to the members of the group and that is about all we can contribute. We give the boys somebody to work on, and we are helping to keep them sober. Next, we find after the meeting is over that somebody has given us a broom—and we have something to hang onto, and to keep our hands steady—and we begin to feel that we belong. And that is when I learned that "service begins on the end of a broom." You immerse yourself in the society of A.A. and you lose sight of your own problems, and you recover—you find yourself in the middle of service. Yes, service is many things. And A.A. works for those who work for A.A.

And what of the future? We can never become so set in our ways that we cannot find new ways to extend the hand of fellowship to alcoholics wherever they may be. We must be flexible without becoming so loose that our methods and our message get watered down. We must maintain stability without becoming so rigid that we cannot bend to meet the changing needs of the still suffering alcoholic. We must find new ways to cooperate with others working in the field of alcoholism without becoming so enmeshed that we lose our own identity and purpose. We must yet find other ways to let the people know about A.A., what we do and where we are. We should never reach the point of pride where we think we have a corner on all the answers, and all the ways. We must have new thoughts, new ideas, new concepts just as the early members did. We'll never run out of alcoholics to work with. There will always be enough to go around.

A Vision for the Future

Your General Service Board, last January approved the formation of a new Trustees' Committee on the future of A.A. Long-range forward planning is a requirement for any corporation expecting to stay in business and not get washed up on the seas of obsolescence. A.A., too, must look for the signs on the horizon. All the forces in the world, working separately and together have only touched the surface in our efforts to help the alcoholic. There must be other answers. There must be ways to improve. The future of A.A. is in your hands, and mine, and in the hands of all A.A. members everywhere. The formula for success is "find a need and fill it." This should be our goal for the future—a vision for you and for me.

We must find a way to get all the members to listen. Another vision for the future is the day when all members of A.A. will have a chance to be exposed to the total service picture.

(cont'd p. 38)

HOSPITALITY COMMITTEE

It seems that there is an improvement each year in the magnificent job done by the Hospitality Committee in providing delegates' wives with entertainment, sightseeing tours and other activities. And this year the committee, made up of local A.A. members, did it again. There was a reception for 150 guests and visits to N.Y.C. Intergroup and Al-Anon headquarters, TV shows, museum tours, an ocean liner, shopping trips, special fashion shows, lectures and lunches. At the same time the committee maintained a hospitality suite where visitors were welcome to chat with local A.A. members who were on duty to give advice and direction.

Digest of Agenda

Monday, April 20

Registration and Tour of G.S.O. and GV
Welcome Session and Keynote – Service
Staff Hi-Lites
G.S.B. and Policy Committee Reports
A.A.W.S. and Dept. Head Reports
Review of Agenda, Committees
Opening Dinner: Regular A.A. Meeting

Tuesday, April 21

Joint Meetings of Trustees and Conference Committees
Conference Committee Meetings
World Service Meeting Report
Board Finance Report and Presentation
Public Information Committee Report
Presentation: Better Cooperation with Organizations in the
Field of Alcoholism

Wednesday, April 22

Twenty Years of Conferences And a Look To The Future
Nominating Committee Report
Trustee-At-Large Election
Presentation & Discussion: "A.A. Members as 'A.A. Counselors'"
Conference Committee Meetings
Delegates' Only Dinner and Meeting

Thursday, April 23

Grapevine Presentation
Report: Area Delegates' Meeting
Presentation: Service, the Heart of A.A.
Literature Committee Report & Presentation
Presentation & Workshop: A.A. Member and Pills
Workshop: General Service Conference Structure

Friday, April 24

Conference Committee Reports
Floor Discussion: Three Questions
Report Back on Workshops
New Tradition Film
Summary of Conference

Saturday, April 25

Closing Brunch

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Each day time was set aside to hear area delegates of Panel 20 report on A.A. in their territories. Excerpts from these are carried on pages 22, 23, and 24.

"ASK-IT-BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered at various times. Summaries appear on pages 31 and 32.

Why We Need a Conference

Bernard B. Smith, former nonalcoholic chairman of the Board of Trustees, and one of the architects of the Conference structure, described the early history and development of the General Service Conference and how he worked close by with Bill in its formation, and how the wisdom of delegates in voicing the group conscience was manifest in its earliest decisions.

In closing, he answered the question of why we need a Conference, and quoted from his opening talk at the 1954 meeting of the Conference:

"We may not need a General Service Conference to insure our own recovery. We do need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness one short block from this room. We need it to insure the recovery of a child being born tonight, destined to alcoholism. We need it to provide, in keeping with our Twelfth Step, a permanent haven for all alcoholics who, in the ages ahead, can find in A.A. that rebirth which brought us back to life.

"We need it because we, more than all others, are conscious of the devastating effect of the human urge for power and prestige which we must insure can never invade A.A. We need it to insure A.A. against government, while insulating it against anarchy; we need it to protect A.A. against disintegration while preventing overintegration. We need it so that Alcoholics Anonymous, and Alcoholics Anonymous alone, is the ultimate repository of its Twelve Steps, its Twelve Traditions and all of its services.

"We need it to insure that changes within A.A. come only as a response to the needs and the wants of all A.A., and not of any few. We need it to insure that the doors of the halls of A.A. never have locks on them, so that all people for all time who have an alcoholic problem may enter these halls unasked and feel welcome. We need it to insure that Alcoholics Anonymous never asks of anyone who needs us what his or her race is, what his or her creed is, what his or her social position is."

DELEGATES ENJOY TOUR OF NEW OFFICE

Usually, on the first day of the Conference, beginning with registration, it is customary for second-year delegates (having the benefit of the previous year's experience) to stride confidently into the General Service Office, knowing exactly where to go and what the routine is for the morning hours before the first Conference session begins at the hotel. They enjoy being "big brothers" to the new panel and are wonderfully helpful in guiding the new delegates through the first-day registration and "get-acquainted" activities.

But this year, everybody, including the G.S.O. staff, had a "freshman" year, for we had been in our brand-new office at 468 Park Avenue South only one week before the Conference opened, hardly time enough for the smartest of us to have found the right corridor to the elevators! So it was especially nice, we all felt, being newcomers together and sharing the excitement of G.S.O.'s "new look" with each other.

Our Responsibility for Service

Presentation

Service, if not continued, could eventually mean the death of this Fellowship which means so much to us.

I feel that one of the greatest moments in our Fellowship was in 1965 when in Toronto each and every one of us present accepted the pledge "I Am Responsible." I firmly believe it was this pledge and the acceptance of it in its full meaning that changed a great many of us who were not willing to serve, to suddenly give of themselves. And I believe that it is the realization of the enormity of this pledge which has caused a great many of us to become more interested in service than ever before. Service to me means a willingness to serve in any capacity whatever, and to be able to interest others in doing likewise.

—Rollie D., Trustee
Eastern Canada Region

INTEREST IN SERVICE GROWS

In the twelve years, or a little over, that I've been in Service work, I've seen it grow to a well organized and well accepted part of our area activities. We had a lot of growing pains in getting groups interested, in keeping G.S.R.'s active, getting to meet public officials, getting programs set up and a million other problems. But thanks to our past delegates, tremendous progress has been made. When I took over as delegate, it was a lot easier for me than it was for them.

Our P.I. program is off the ground and we have a wonderful working relationship with outside agencies, such as hospitals, state, city and county alcoholism agencies, prisons and community organizations.

We make talks to high schools and any other civic organization or club that may ask us. We are now trying to get a program set up with industry and have been invited to talk at different Union meetings.

As you can see, our P.I. Committee is a very active one and we are proud of them. They also work with the newspapers and have a very good working relationship with them.

—Joe C., S.E. Michigan

PLENTY OF DRUNKS TO GO AROUND

Much has been written about "Service" and much "service" has been rendered — however, the world seems to be making more drunks than any "one" can take care of. As someone so aptly put it, "Don't fight anyone in the field of alcoholism; there are plenty of drunks to go around."

The Greater St. Louis Metropolitan Area has a population of 2,400,000 and an estimated alcoholic population between 75,000 and 80,000. Many glowing reports have been written about St. Louis Alcoholic Treatment Centers, and justifiably so. However, their success cannot be measured to any degree by A.A.'s application of the Second and Third Legacies as a total effort. True, these Alcoholism Treatment Centers utilize A.A.'s services. Unfortunately, A.A.'s services are most often carried out through the efforts of dedicated individual members rather than as a coordinated effort of the total A.A. community.

The best service we can perform as individuals is carrying the message to the still sick, sorry, and suffering alcoholic. As we all know, this is best done "eyeball to eyeball." To deny the recovering alcoholic, as well as the sick one, this privilege can be dangerous. In relating our story we give "hope to the hopeless." This is the language of the heart!

—Zora H., E. Missouri

SERVICE IS CARRYING THE MESSAGE

The "I Am Responsible" pledge personifies our 1970 Conference theme, "Service — The Heart of A.A." for it is only when we accept responsibility collectively as well as individually for anyone, anywhere, that we can enable ourselves to effectively try to carry the message to anyone, anywhere.

This is the basic service all activities should lead to, directly or indirectly, and any which do not result in this are superfluous and can be dispensed with. To give service, we are obligated to keep ourselves informed by visiting as many groups in our areas as possible and speaking with members in order to sense the group conscience firsthand; to meet with district committee members and G.S.R.'s at regular intervals; to keep ourselves informed as to Bill's writings, as well as Conference-approved pamphlets, and to maintain regular contact with G.S.O.

I find I become better informed in my area by also attending monthly meetings of the General Service, Institutional and Southern California Convention committees, as well as periodic contact with the P.I. representatives. By this individual effort I am kept aware of the collective experience, strength, and hope to be shared thereby.

It is through this sharing that I comfortably retain my day-to-day sobriety and maintain an awareness that is of paramount importance to me. It seems our lines of communication are strengthened in proportion to our awareness; and of course, the stronger these are, the better informed we become; the better informed we are, the better equipped we are to accept responsibility; the more capably we accept responsibility, the more the message is carried, the stronger we grow collectively and so more comfortable is our personal sobriety.

—Art K., So. California

How Can A.A. Better Cooperate With Organizations in the Field of Alcoholism

Presentation

John R., regional trustee to the General Service Board from the Western Canada Region, chaired this presentation and shared some of his own and his area's experience in this field. Following the talks of the panel members, a lively floor discussion took place, the consensus of which is reported below.

EDUCATION OF PROFESSIONALS

It was my privilege several years ago to have served as director of Alcoholism Education for a provincial organization. During that time we were able to conduct an attitude survey on alcoholism and the alcoholic over the entire province. The attitudes of 75% of professional people showed a surprising lack of understanding, antipathy and even disgust.

An educational program was established and centered around local committees composed of cross sections of the community, including A.A. and Al-Anon. Regular study and discussion meetings were held and plans laid out to bring about attitude changes through education.

This program has worked very successfully in a few areas, but lack of financial support and dedicated leadership has hindered progress in others. One experiment which seems to hold promise is the holding of panel discussions where the panelists consist of A.A. members and Al-Anon members, as well as representatives of all professional and social agencies concerned with the problem of alcoholism.

Several of these have been organized in our area and have proved successful. Criteria for their success seems to be good organization, plenty of publicity (well-known names of non-alcoholic participants can be an attraction) and an experienced A.A. chairman.

These meetings seem to attract a much broader segment of the community than regular A.A. public meetings. In meetings of this type alcoholism can be discussed in much greater scope and leads to a better understanding of the total problem.

—Hugh S., Nova Scotia

WORKING CLOSELY WITH OTHERS

Question: How does your area go about cooperating with organizations in the field of alcoholism? In reply: We probably take a negative approach. Experience in our area has taught us this is best.

A lot of famous people have uttered some famous last words. To me, the most important of all were said by Doctor Bob in 1950—"Keep it simple." More than ever in our complex society these words take on more significance.

If doctors, psychiatrists, clergy and others agree that we have a greater percentage of recovery, let's not affiliate ourselves with them—let's work closely with them and take the sick man to meetings with us. He has a chance that way. The sooner we separate him from theory, medication and fear, and associate him with hope, facts and recovery, his chances will improve.

Our program in North Carolina consists of the following:

1. Assist in getting people from various counseling services to the meetings.
2. Assist in providing written material.
3. Provide *qualified* speakers when requested by various organizations.
4. Provide open meetings with the public invited.
5. Education.
6. Meetings inside prisons and hospitals.
7. Liaison with courts.

Let's keep in mind—act in accordance with our Traditions! Carry the message—don't put on a show. If we get involved in areas other than sponsorship and getting people to their first meeting, we are in error.

—Wade J., North Carolina

Discussion followed concerning the question: "How can A.A. better cooperate with organizations in the field of alcoholism?"

1. One area stressed the importance of using diplomacy in speaking to doctors in hospitals and to be sure not to interfere with the doctors' treatment or diagnosis of a patient. It was suggested that the rules of an institution be followed, and if the rules are not liked, just don't go into such an institution.
2. One area feels their cooperation is a success because they do not try to tell a professional how to run his business, but simply ask if there is any way in which A.A. can be helpful.
3. It was felt that more interns and residents in hospitals were beginning to receive more training in the field of alcoholism. One of A.A.'s responsibilities is to see and to insure that A.A. members becoming involved in outside facilities bring something to these activities, over and above A.A. membership. It was suggested that they have some training so they will know what *not* to do. A.A. should never be professionalized.
4. One area has a very effective program set up to help alcoholics and the A.A. members are working closely with them, though not affiliated.

'The Message Is in the Literature!'

Presentation

Our first and most important means of carrying the message of A.A. is through our own shared experience, person to person, but the second could certainly be considered to be our Conference-approved literature. Austin MacCormick, Chairman of the Trustees' Literature Committee, reported some of the Committee's Literature activities during 1969 before introducing the panel members.

In developing a literature program which will incorporate the widest possible range of A.A. thinking and experience, certain checks and balances and methods of procedure have been adopted:

DEVELOPING A PROGRAM

1. First, the *idea* behind the pamphlets is born. This can come about as a suggestion received from an A.A. member in any part of our A.A. world, from a member of the staff, from a trustee, service director, or from the A.A. Grapevine.
2. Next, the general manager and each staff member is consulted about the suggestion, and it is then referred to the Trustees' Literature Committee. If this committee feels that the idea merits further exploration, it is then brought to the directors of A.A. World Services.
3. When the idea has been approved by both the Trustees' Literature Committee and the directors of A.A.W.S., it is submitted to the Conference Literature Committee and then, if all are in agreement that the idea should be pursued, the general manager assigns a writer to the project, and the manuscript it prepared.

—Mac B., D.C.

MANY REQUESTS FOR REPRINTS

We get many requests for reprints from the U.S. and many foreign countries. All of them are carefully reviewed by our staff members who are highly experienced and then by the directors of A.A.W.S. Since all of our books and pamphlets are copyrighted, permission should be obtained for any reprints.

In the United States, A.A.W.S. does not normally give permission to reprint any of our material in whole or in any large part. Consequently, requests are usually for excerpts from books or pamphlets, most of which are for institutions, individuals, or other organizations interested in the field of alcoholism. We are interested in helping any effort that is sincere and try very hard not to deny reprint permission to responsible people.

We encourage foreign countries to print any or all of our material, including the Big Book whenever the volume justifies such an operation. These often involve translations which we check for accuracy. In some cases we recommend that one literature center service several countries where the language is the same.

—Steve O., General Service Trustee,
Trustees' Literature Committee

NONALCOHOLICS INFORMED, TOO

For every person out there in the small communities and in the large; for Loners all over the world, the MESSAGE is in the literature. No one will deny the value of meetings and the personal contacts, but this is a program dedicated to growth and the way to GROW, for me, is to read and re-read the Big Book, "12 and 12," "A.A. Comes of Age," "A.A. Traditions," "Alcoholism the Illness," "Twelve Concepts of World Services," The Group Handbook, to name a few.

We display the pamphlets at meetings. Hopefully, the secretary does not forget to mention that pamphlets are available, and she urges newcomers to help themselves. Regular members are urged to keep a supply at home to use on Twelfth Step calls. The pamphlets furnish exceptional material for closed meeting discussions. Our pamphlets and books are of infinite value in informing nonalcoholics who may be attending our open meetings.

—Mary Elizabeth S.
Trustees' Literature Committee

GROUPS DISCUSS PAMPHLETS

At the 1969 meeting of the General Service Conference Literature Committee, a more effective display was discussed. Our area committee developed an "eye-catching" display which shows all the literature available from G.S.O.

Early in 1969, through our committee meeting, we were able to convey to the groups the importance of each group electing a Literature and Grapevine chairman, with the result that most groups have gone along with this plan. Although the group Literature chairman is responsible for the upkeep and distribution of literature, we mail a literature reminder each month to our district committee members, requesting that they work closely with their group Literature chairman on this all-important phase of recovery.

At our last committee meeting in February, we found that a number of groups had accepted our suggestion to conduct a closed meeting occasionally, using one of our Conference-approved pamphlets as a subject. If this is followed, members who have not read much of the literature will hear something that will "strike home."

—Al D., Washington State

Grapevine Carries A.A. Message

Presentation

The purpose of the A.A. Grapevine is to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics by sharing A.A. experience, A.A. thinking, A.A. news and a sense of the strength and hope and joy that comes from practicing A.A. principles in all our affairs. We have to begin by practicing A.A. principles in the Grapevine.

One of the first of those A.A. principles is that we are self-supporting. We do not carry paid advertising. Wherever a magazine depends on revenue from advertising there is always the temptation to increase that revenue by slanting the contents to please an advertiser. The A.A. message is too precious to take a chance on corrupting it.

Another principle of A.A. applies when we consider that the Grapevine exists only to carry the message of A.A. We must guard against propaganda that advances any causes or any interests of individuals that do not relate to our primary purpose.

A magazine, like life itself, however, would be terribly bland if there were never any controversy to make things a little more exciting. In A.A. there are as many differing opinions as there are alcoholics. We print, and in fact, welcome, diverse points of view from within the Fellowship. We have a continuous controversy between atheists and the believers, between those who want to talk only about drinking and those who want to talk about all sorts of problems. This makes for better reading and a more interesting magazine, we feel. We try, however, to make it quite clear that the opinions expressed are those of the writer — the individual member of A.A.

Finally, in connection with Grapevine policy, I do not feel that the Grapevine is any place for personal journalism. If an editor has a cause to promote, he should promote it elsewhere. The Grapevine is, in its way, affecting the very lives of thousands of people. Only the group conscience guided by a loving God can carry such an awesome responsibility.

— Jack M., Editor

A MEETING IN PRINT

In "A.A. Comes of Age," Bill W., characterizes the Grapevine as "our biggest and best means of communicating current A.A. thought and experience in staying sober, in hanging together, and in service."

As editors of the Grapevine we view the magazine as a journal or forum for the presentation of individual A.A. opinion and experience; it has often been called "a meeting in print" and (Bill's words) "a sort of magic carpet on which all of us can travel from one distant A.A. outpost to another. . . ."

Who are our readers? They are A.A. members generally — both men and women, newcomers, oldtimers, midtimers, Loners, Internationalists and, we believe, a significant number of still suffering alcoholics. All are kept in mind as each issue is planned. We try to strike a balance between the more serious and thoughtful material and the light and humorous.

Who writes the Grapevine? Almost without exception, the readers and subscribers to the magazine. Over the years, the volume of mail and manuscripts have doubled and the quality of material has reached a high level. Another source of material is G.S.O. correspondence. The Grapevine and G.S.O. circulate all mail so that all of us are aware of and share in the happenings of A.A. worldwide.

—Paula C., Managing Editor

GV REMAINS TRUE TO TWELVE TRADITIONS

Like everything in our Fellowship — every group, every new service board, every piece of literature — the A.A. Grapevine came into being because of a specific need. It was first published twenty-five years ago, in June, 1944, to bring meetings in print to servicemen away from home.

It was very well received and much appreciated, so much that members at home began to ask for it. So in 1945 we turned to the groups and asked their wishes. The response was heavily in favor of publishing the Grapevine as the A.A. magazine for all.

Since September, 1948, the Grapevine has been published in its present pocket-size, magazine format. But it did not start out that way. It was first published as a small newspaper — which was not only easier to mail, but it was cheaper to produce, and money was something we did not have. As a matter of fact, for the next twenty years, the Grapevine was supported by the General Service Board, out of the General Fund, until in 1964 it became self-supporting. It was then able to repay its loan of \$11,000 to the General Fund, and each year since 1967 has been able to contribute a few thousand dollars to this very Fund which once supported it.

We struggled, we made mistakes, and we learned. But there is one thing in particular of which we can be most proud: resisting natural, human temptations to use spectacular editorial and promotional techniques, we remained true to the Twelve Traditions of A.A. and to our primary purpose of sharing experience, strength, and hope with our readers.

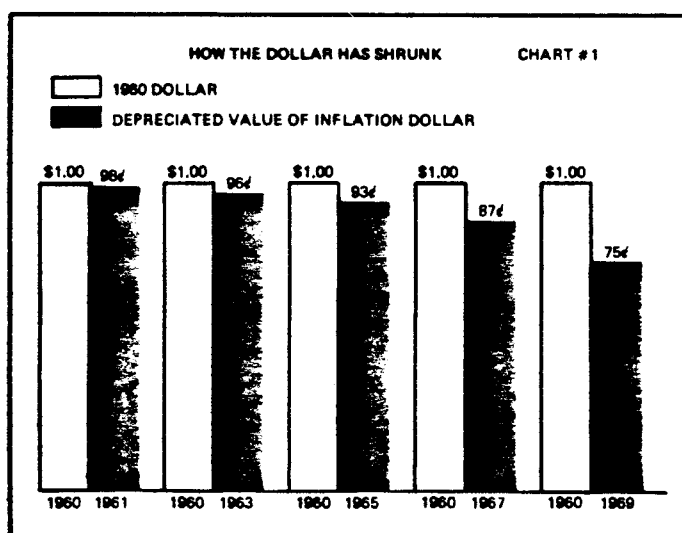
Our circulation has grown from 2,000 in 1945 to our present paid circulation of over 55,000.

—Ruth W., Treasurer

G.S.O. and a Decade of Inflation

Inflation is not a popular subject, but it is a real and ever-present problem. Everyone of us is aware of the fact that the dollar does not buy as much today as it did ten years ago. How much has the dollar actually shrunk over the past decade? Based on Bureau of Labor Statistics reports, in the period from 1960 to 1969, inflation has depreciated the dollar to the extent that it is now worth only seventy-five cents. As illustrated in chart number one, the greater part of this shrinkage has taken place over the past five years.

As our Fellowship grows, so do the cost of services rise. To keep the Fellowship healthy, group contributions must not only increase to cover growth, they must also keep pace with inflation.



In the period from 1960 to 1969, inflation has depreciated the dollar to the extent that it is now worth only seventy-five cents.

Chart #1 reminds us that contributions must keep pace with inflation, as well as the increased cost of service expenses, for an ever-expanding fellowship.

In 1960, there were 8,615 groups worldwide. Today, ten years later, there are 15,614 groups. This represents a growth factor in excess of 80%. Year after year, this expansion continues. And obviously, there is a resulting increase in expenses to service these additional groups. The annual increases in group contributions have just about kept up with this growth—but, unfortunately, this has not been sufficient because the dollar has less purchasing power each year.

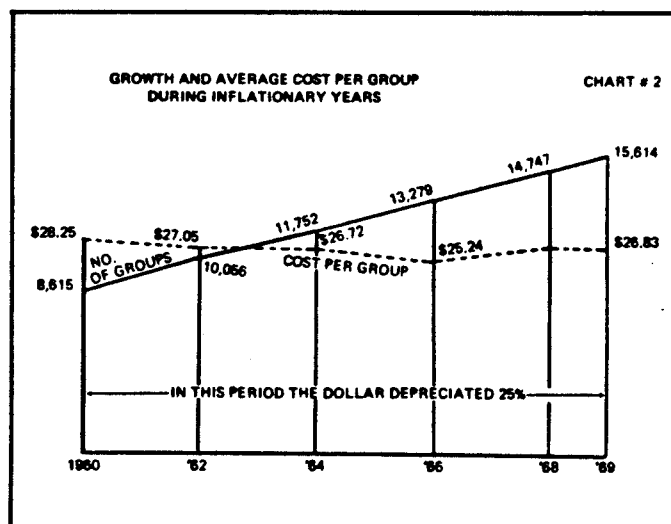
Chart number two shows how G.S.O. has managed to cope with the situation during these inflationary years. Without reducing group services, constant striving for increased efficiency of operation has kept the service cost per group from rising. In terms of dollars, the average service cost per group actually decreased from \$28.25 per year to \$26.83. This has been accomplished in many ways. . . utilization of cheaper postal rates for all mailings; acknowledging contributions quarterly, via a micro-filing system, rather than as received; a printing program

effecting many economies which included a cheaper and better way of printing the *World Directory*; careful attention to budgets, and so on. . . And of course, most important of all, the willingness of those at G.S.O. to take on greater workloads, thus keeping the addition of new employees at a minimum.

When the average cost of servicing each group is adjusted to the 1960 dollar, average service costs per group actually decreased from \$28.25 to \$20.26 per year, as illustrated in chart number three.

Methods of employing the contribution dollar more efficiently have been just about exhausted. With continuing inflation, costs must rise.

In the past, publishing income has helped to offset group fund deficits. However, with higher costs of doing business, less reliance must be placed on this source of income and more emphasis placed on contributions from groups. How well have group contributions done in the past? Chart number four shows us that when contributions are adjusted to the 1960 dollar (represented by the solid portion of the contribution bars) yearly increases in contributions for the past three years have just barely kept pace with inflation (represented by the shaded portion of the contribution bars) with no additional increases to cover growth and the resulting increase in service expenses. In fact, the purchasing power of the contributions received in 1969 was less than the purchasing power of the contributions received in 1967!



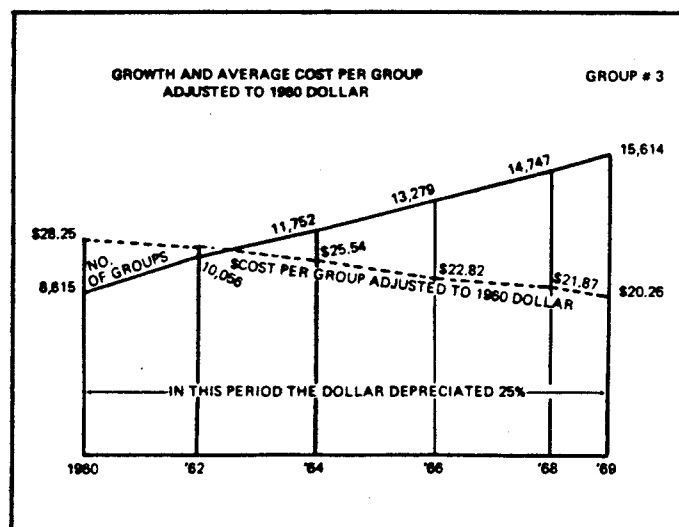
Year after year, the Fellowship grows – but unfortunately the dollar has less purchasing power each year. Chart #2 shows that without reducing group services, constant striving for increased efficiency has kept the service cost per group from rising.

Groups overseas, because of a lower economy, and institutional groups for obvious reasons, can only afford to make token contributions to the cost of General Services. Therefore, regular groups in the U.S. and Canada are responsible for 98.5%

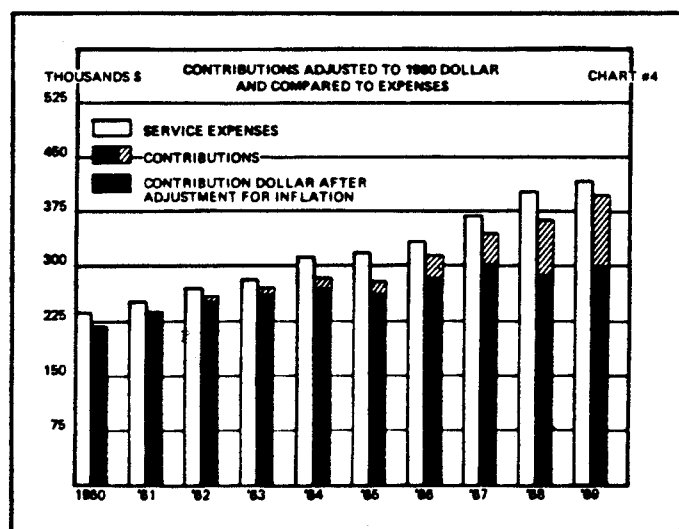
of all service costs. How well are the groups in the U.S. and Canada supporting G.S.O. today? By looking at chart five, we can see that the percentage of groups participating today have only increased very slightly over 1960. With more than an 80% increase in the number of groups over the last ten-year period, this means that there are more groups *not* contributing today than there were in 1960.

We are certain that if the non-contributing groups, representing 37% of all regular groups in the U.S. and Canada, were aware of the importance of their support, that support would be forthcoming.

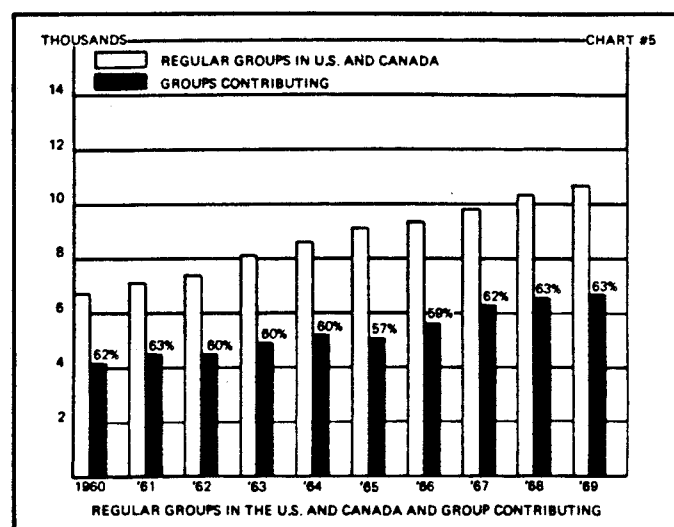
—Dennis Manders, Controller



Adjusting the cost per group to the 1960 base, average service costs actually decreased from \$28.25 to \$20.26. Methods of employing the contribution dollar more efficiently have been exhausted. With continuing inflation, costs must rise.



When contributions are adjusted to the 1960 dollar (solid portion of contribution bars) chart #4 illustrates that the yearly increases in contributions for the past three years have just barely kept pace with inflation (represented by the shaded portion of the contribution bars) with no additional increases to cover growth and the resulting increase in service expenses.



Groups overseas, because of a lower economy, and institutional groups for obvious reasons, can only afford to make token contributions to the cost of general services. Therefore, regular groups in the U.S. and Canada are responsible for 98.5% of all service costs.

How well are the groups in the U.S. and Canada supporting G.S.O. today? Chart #5 shows that in 1960 62% of the groups were participating. In 1969, ten years later, there were still only 63% participating.

Pertaining to the question: "How can the percentage of groups contributing to G.S.O. be improved in order to meet financial responsibilities?" the following experience was shared:

1. During a "Gratitude Month," G.S.R.'s and committee members asked their groups for gratitude contributions.
2. One area increased districts from four to ten, hoping that individual groups, through committee members, would become better acquainted with G.S.O. and need for additional funds.
3. Set up a panel of three people who are invited to G.S.R. meetings. One member, a G.S.R. who speaks on his/her duties. Second member, a committee member, explains the area committee and how it fits into service picture. Third member speaks about G.S.O., the General Service Conference, etc. He tries to encourage G.S.R.'s to give their names, addresses, meeting places, etc. to G.S.O. and to tell them why money is needed and for what use.
4. One delegate visits all groups in his area and asks each chairman for 3 to 5 minutes to talk to group. He covers G.S.O. and need for money.
5. Birthday Plan and Gratitude Month work well in some areas. Suggested that G.S.O. compile guidelines regarding finances for distribution to members involved in service work.
6. One state has appointed a finance chairman whose duties are to see that the state committee has sufficient funds for which to operate.

Problem of A.A. Member and Pills

Presentation

Many years ago when A.A. was first beginning to be generally known, the question came up at a meeting of the Board about what our attitude should be toward narcotic users. This was before many of the tranquilizers that we are excited about today came into the picture at all. When we spoke about narcotics, we meant morphine and heroin, and the other things that today we call hard drugs.

When people in trouble with these hard drugs came to A.A. meetings, there was considerable apprehension on the part of A.A. members; a feeling that addicts didn't belong. And for one reason or other these people didn't seem to be able to recover from their addiction through the A.A. group.

One of the things that has made trouble between A.A. and the professionals has been our emotional reaction to any kind of chemical. Many of you know as well as I that people who have had serious medical difficulties, who have required continuous medication of one sort or another, have been afraid to come to A.A. meetings for fear they would not be allowed to stay if they continued their medication.

With all the best intentions, we have made trouble and created misunderstanding between us who need so much to work together in complete confidence and understanding if we are going to save more people from the hell that you know so well. Increasingly, because of the multiplication of these chemicals and because of their increased effectiveness, more and more people who are dependent on alcohol are also dependent, or are becoming dependent, on these other things.

So let us keep an open mind, let's keep flexible. Let's not be frightened, but continue to see people as people, to see them as individuals and try in the good A.A. way to give of ourselves to them whenever they reach out for help.

—John L. Norris, M.D., Chm.,
General Service Board

PILLS SUBSTITUTE FOR ALCOHOL

I am frequently asked what to do with a member who, although he or she has stopped drinking, has substituted pills for alcohol and shows up at meetings high on drugs. In general, my suggestions have conformed to the "written word" as put down in our Twelve Traditions, particularly the Third Tradition which says, "The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking." I also recommend the member in question read our pamphlet, "Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic," as well as his sponsor.

In my own group, one female member was recently confined to a mental hospital, one male member has become mentally incompetent, and another female member of 15 years, who has "passed out" from an overdose of barbiturates during

an open meeting, seldom attends meetings any more, due to her embarrassment. This particular person refuses to tell her doctor she is an alcoholic for fear he will not prescribe for her the medication that relieves her physical ailments other than alcoholism.

We should encourage frank and objective discussion of the problem, not sweep it under the rug. Members who have "licked" the drug problem should be encouraged to share their experience with others in the group and finally, members should be encouraged to read A.A. literature in which the problem of drugs is discussed in terms of A.A. experience.

Yes, we do have a problem in our area and we are searching for help. Let's "kick it around" seriously in our workshops and come up with more and better service for members in this category, who are at present a minority, before they become a majority.

—Ted C., Ala./N.W. Fla.

MIXING ALCOHOL AND PILLS

It is doubtful if there are more than a few individuals who may be termed pure alcoholics. Today, the majority of problem drinkers take sedatives for sleeping, stimulants for arousal and tranquilizers for peace of mind. This is in addition to the state of affairs which pertains when the subject cannot obtain sufficient alcohol for his purpose and must fall back upon the use of substitutes.

A certain proportion of alcoholics prefer alcohol if it is available. However, they are not sufficiently narrow-minded to undergo the physical and emotional stresses of total sobriety when these agonies can be avoided through the utilization of substitutes. Many others, however, are addicted to drugs; they, too, are sufficiently elastic in their attitudes to use alcohol upon occasion. Although this may sometimes serve as a substitute for drugs, sometimes it is used as a cover-up or a smoke-screen for an unacceptable drug habit.

I feel: (1) Even a closed meeting has open doors to all who benefit from attending and this is an individual decision and not a collective one to be foisted upon anyone. The sole exception concerns the habitual "disrupter" of meetings. (2) The narcotic addict as such cannot be expected to benefit significantly from the A.A. program and should have a program of his own. (3) The youthful users of illicit drugs in general have no place in A.A. meetings while they so vociferously oppose the establishment. However, one can expect a switch to alcohol eventually by many of these people; then A.A. will be their "cup of tea." (4) There is no reason for closing the A.A. door to other drug users nor for the setting up of special meetings for them.

—Travis Dancey, M.D., Trustee
Montreal, Canada

Strength of A.A. Is Single-Mindedness

The source of strength that I find from A.A. is its single-mindedness, the extraordinary single-mindedness which is so clear: The mission of A.A. is to help alcoholics.

I think that behind your single-mindedness is the strength of humility, because you limit what you are demanding of yourself and your associates. And from this comes real success. Supposing you were arrogant enough to say that this is a cure for everything, so you take on cancer. Then you would find pretty soon that you would get mad at your cancer patients because they fail to appreciate you. You would become more and more abrasive and destructive of the very kindness, the very strength you have. So I think it's very important to all alcoholics and all people in this Fellowship that you stay strong and successful. Don't dilute and deceive yourselves. That's not to say there are not other problems. But to believe that the process that is very successful in one line is guaranteed of success because of this worthiness, would be a very serious mistake. I don't believe for a moment that the Fellowship would ever make that mistake. I think the Traditions are too strong. But I think it needs to be reaffirmed.

Open-minded approach to treatment of addiction important

In my own professional field I think we have approached this problem of treating the heroin addict in an open-minded way. I am not for or against narcotics, I surely am against what narcotics do to addicts when they are abused. But the question is "What am I trying to accomplish, where is my mission?" And in this I really have been very much influenced by the A.A. Tradition — that your mission is to help the sick alcoholic and mine is to help the heroin addict against the criticism of the medical profession and other people. If I can enable people, who are otherwise locked into a life of crime to help them to become productive, self-respecting citizens, then I have nothing to apologize for in the group that I represent. And I think this is a wonderfully clarifying view. At every point, whatever the criticism or the temptations in this field, I simply ask myself the relevant question that you have in A.A., "Does this help the addict?"

Working without controversy

As a matter of fact, this rather simple guide helped me a great deal today. This morning I had three separate telephone calls, wanting me to appear on national television. It is a powerfully tempting thing to do; you know everybody likes to see his picture in the papers. But I ask myself again, "Does this help the addict?" No, it's just my own vanity that could be served, and suppose that I even permitted my patients to be exposed to television, in the long run it would be detrimental to their own development to identify them as addicts. So I declined. I think I help the addicts more by working quietly and professionally, speaking to medical groups, working to obtain good data, collect good evaluation, working without controversy, as far as possible, just to bring treatment first.

Now this is what I've learned from A.A. You are more effective if you stay single-minded and humble.

— Vincent P. Dole, M.D., Trustee
General Service Board

Following are questions and answers discussed at the Workshop on the problems of A.A. members and pills.

Q. "Should an A.A. member dry from alcohol for a long time and taking prescribed medication for heart and other conditions, be qualified to serve as an A.A. group officer?"

A. Yes, providing he adheres to the doctor's instruction.

Q. "How can a member who has never taken pills sponsor someone who has a combined problem of alcohol and pills?"

A. Many have never been confronted with this problem, but we can be open-minded. We should not refuse to be sponsors under these conditions, but, if possible, sponsorship could best be taken care of by an individual who has had such experience. The problem of the pill should be brought out in the open and when sponsoring, tell of the dangers. It was noted little success for sobriety can be expected until those seeking help made an admission. The pamphlet, "Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic" is very valuable here.

(It was suggested that even for those without this dual problem, it would be wise for the new member to tell and retell his doctor about his alcoholism, so that he would not be confronted later with the pill problem.)

Q. "What can we do to help the person who uses 'mood changing' drugs, pills, narcotics, LSD, marijuana, etc., who claims to have a drinking problem?"

A. We can present the A.A. program as we would for any person, always mindful of our Traditions, and explain that some have a pill and drug problem. If he is on drugs and feels the A.A. program cannot help him, then he should be referred to a professional for help.

Q. "If A.A. members, free from alcohol, receive medication during a hospital visit, are they still considered to be sober members of A.A.?"

A. Yes, providing instructions are followed. It was pointed out that too many A.A.'s set themselves up as authorities over the medical profession.

Q. "If hospital and prison officials order patients or prisoners who are not alcoholics, but who have other problems, such as drug addiction, psychosis, etc. to attend A.A. meetings, is there anything we as A.A. members can or should do about it?"

A. On the assumption that this applies to 'inside' meetings, there is nothing we can do about admittance. We should not contravene an order or help an inmate to do so. We can and should, however, in a tactful manner, be sure officials of institutions understand our position and purpose.

(continued on p. 30)

Should We Have Concern About Members Employed as 'A.A. Counselors'?

Presentation

As a result of the following question being asked at G.S.O., "Should A.A. be concerned about members being employed as 'A.A. counselors' when traditionally, A.A. is not to be professionalized," we hope to give you an enlightening sharing of experience through these panel members.

—Don F., *Chairman*
General Service Regional Trustee

'A.A. COUNSELOR' IS MISNOMER

While in some instances the term "A.A. Counselor" is descriptive of the duties of its holder, it is more often a misnomer, frequently applied to individual members of A.A. whose function as counselors on A.A. is only incidental to other counseling, administrative, clerical or even custodial duties. While this title is gaining increasing public acceptance, the use may be in violation of the Eleventh Tradition.

It is, however, my belief that anyone with expertise in any area of the treatment of the alcoholic is entitled to counsel in that area and carry the title of a counselor on alcoholism, although we in A.A. should try to discourage the present and expanding use of the term "A.A. Counselor."

As for the employment of A.A. members as alcoholism counselors, I feel that we have a somewhat different situation. Paid Twelfth Step work, in the case of charging an individual for A.A. counseling done is, of course, out of the question, but with the growth of public interest in alcoholism and alcoholism programs, the mandatory deprivation of many highly worthwhile public services of the benefits of A.A. participation would be a major tragedy.

Members of A.A. in the clergy, social service, psychiatry, psychology, general medicine, social and personnel work, etc., find frequent occasion to do Twelfth Step work and counseling on time for which they are paid. Dedicated A.A.'s who can be as effective as professionals in presenting the A.A. program, should NOT be deprived of the opportunity to do so because of any formal stand by A.A.

—Alex B., *D.C.*

A.A.'S ARE NONPROFESSIONAL

I feel that if I were employed as a counselor, or a worker with alcoholics, I should not consider myself an A.A. counselor. Our Traditions have taught us that this we must not do. I feel that people who are professionals in the field of alcoholism counseling have been, or should have been, educated in this field and if they are A.A. members, should keep the two separate as we have been taught and have learned through experience.

Many people we know who are A.A. members have been able to do this and their counseling, done in hospitals, rehabilitation centers, or clinics, has been done as an employee of the institution, and have kept their affiliation separate from A.A.

I feel that the name "A.A." as such should not be used in connection with any institutional service on alcoholism, even though the counselor is a member of A.A. He or she should be labeled a "counselor on alcoholism," and the name of the A.A. should be left out entirely from his or her title or reference.

It is understandable why institutions and Councils on Alcoholism like to employ members of A.A. because of their personal understanding of the problems of the alcoholic, but such a person is not an A.A. representative. The fact that he is a member of A.A. does not give him the right to use the A.A. name, and it is misleading to the public which is apt to think that the counselor represents A.A. instead of the institution.

—Paul S., *W. Missouri*

CENTERS HAVE NO A.A. TIES

This question has bothered me since my early A.A. days, when we brought A.A. to the mental hospital that services our area. The usual alcoholic population ran from thirty to fifty men and women, mostly men. A common practice twenty years ago was to select some nonalcoholic, usually at random, to give counsel to the alcoholic patients. I don't need to tell you he got nowhere, and often resentment would set in.

Today I am chairman of the Advisory Board of the Rehabilitation Center in my area, and am familiar with many of the woes that seem to plague some centers. We have a six-county project responsible for raising money for our own operations. The Center has absolutely no functional ties with our A.A. group. An alcoholic is hospitalized briefly, he is counseled about his problems, a job is found for him, if necessary.

If I were to find fault with our operation, it would be to claim that it has taken the pleasure out of Twelfth Step work for our members. And we have found ourselves hard put to produce sponsors for the new men as fast as they come to our group. Some would say, "That is good." I'm not sure that I can say that. We have received much publicity, all favorable, and when an alcoholic problem shows up, people call the Center and never call another A.A.

I probably wouldn't be concerned about this, but having been in A.A. for a long time I well remember our great enthusiasm and something seems to be taking its place, which could be called "apathy." Though the overall situation is good in Iowa, there are a few situations where a kind of rigor mortis seems to be setting in, and one cannot help but ask "What can I possibly do to help the situation?"

—Bob A., *Iowa*

...Suggest Term 'A.A. Counselor' Be Dropped

Following are some comments from the floor regarding the question, "Should A.A. be concerned about A.A. members being employed as 'A.A. Counselors' when traditionally A.A. is not to be professionalized?"

"I strongly suggest that the term 'A.A. Counselor' be dropped. What we have done so far is not enough; as A.A. members, we must function within our Traditions . . ."



"We have no objection to anyone working as a counselor. However, if a member uses the title 'A.A. Counselor' he would be representing A.A. as a whole, and therefore would need approval from A.A. as a whole . . ."

"Most of the people at a local center are A.A. members but other than using the A.A. philosophy in their rehabilitation program they do not affiliate the A.A. name with the center. . ."



"The harm stems from the title and not the individual, as it implies that we are affiliated with hospitals, etc. No one should be denied the privilege of knowing about A.A. When people hear the name 'A.A. counselor' they may think this means that A.A. also takes care of jobs, marriage counseling and other problems . . ."

"We should contact those people in the professional field who are advertising the title 'A.A. counselor' and ask them to keep the A.A. name out of their advertisement for employment . . ."

"I think it is important in these centers to have people who are equipped in other areas, such as psychiatry and marriage counseling, as well as A.A. Not everyone will make it just with the A.A. program . . ."



"I can't help but think I like the idea of seeing some of these outside agencies hiring A.A.'s. If the member has other qualifications plus A.A., I don't think there is anyone more equipped. The danger lies in that sooner or later, one of these A.A.'s is going to do something wrong, and this is what people will remember. By using the title 'A.A. Counselor,' he will involve the whole Fellowship . . ."

"In my area the government has a program going which consists of helping rehabilitate drug addicts and alcoholics. The man put in charge of this program began advertising for 'a director of A.A.' This man wrote to G.S.O., who in turn contacted me, since this man was in my area. I met with him and explained our Traditions, and felt I had established a good understanding. I feel it is up to the delegates in each area to try

and clear up situations like this when they are brought to our attention . . ."

"I feel A.A. has a program of recovery to offer, not a program of treatment. Leave this up to the professionals. I brought up this question before my area and they voted a flat 'no' against the use of this term . . ."

"Is it possible that our staff consider writing up some kind of guidelines on this subject for wide distribution within the Fellowship and possibly guidelines for industry, also?"

* * *

A motion was made and carried that the 20th General Service Conference go on record as opposing the use of the title "A.A. Counselor."

'A.A. SERVICE MANUAL' GUIDE FOR REDISTRICTING

The following is a consensus of replies reported from the Workshop on the General Service Conference Structure:

1. When the General Service Structure needs redistricting, nearly all areas use the new "A.A. Service Manual" as a guide (page 49). The "A.A. Service Manual" is a revised edition of the "Third Legacy Manual," copyrighted in 1959. Some of our smaller areas set up a program of redistricting which is best suited for their needs at a particular time.
2. Chairmen of committees, such as Institutions, Public Information, Grapevine, Literature and others are not members of the General Service Conference area committee in most areas. In some areas, the chairman of the Institutions Committee is accepted as a committee member. Unless the chairmen of these various committees are G.S.R.'s or district committee members, they have no vote at an assembly meeting and are not eligible for delegate, alternate, or officer. Naturally, assembly vote determines.
3. Communication in all Conference areas is improving rapidly. This is being done through round robins, intergroup meetings, exchange of speakers among groups, birthday parties, newsletters, pamphlets, Grapevine, TV and radio announcements.
4. Our new Service Manual has been enthusiastically received in all areas. It has stimulated interest and enabled more members to become involved in service.
5. In sparsely populated areas, when there are limited numbers of district committee members, G.S.R.'s are eligible to become delegates if assembly votes to do so.

Delegates Discuss Area Problems

During the Conference a number of questions were presented to delegates for floor discussion. Two of them, along with various comments, follow:

1. **What is the opinion of the Conference on soliciting business by an A.A. member at a meeting? That is, selling life insurance, beauty products, or other services. What steps can be taken to prevent it?**

"In our area this usually happens with newcomers. These people are hard put economically when they first join A.A., and we find the problem usually eliminates itself once they are better settled economically . . ."

"I am a shellfish dealer and sell from the back end of my truck. At times I have been asked to open up my wagon to sell lobsters, etc. at conferences and meetings, which I will not do. My sponsor told me many years ago at no time to do business at any A.A. meeting, and I wish we had more sponsors like that . . ."

"This question was brought up at a sharing session in my area and they felt we should stop such a person and let him know why he's in the program. Better to step on a person's toes than to let him get drunk. Another person said he objected to anyone trying to sell him religion at a meeting . . ."

"We don't have this problem in my area, but would it not be a good idea for the chairman to ask that all announcements be given to him at the beginning of a meeting and ask that no solicitations or other announcements be made during the meeting . . .?"

"As a lawyer, and I'm sure this happens to many other A.A. lawyers and doctors, I am constantly asked at meetings for my professional opinion. I put a stop to this by announcing they should come to my office because then I could charge them . . ."

2. **There is a growing tendency to lionize people in A.A. solely on the basis of their profession, occupation or chronological age. In most cases, this makes it more difficult for the person to obtain sobriety and is actually doing him a disservice. There should be no elite in A.A. What can be done to reverse this trend?**

"I feel very strongly about this because there are many people who are embarrassed by this practice. At the other end of the spectrum there are some who find it very heady medicine . . ."

"One of the reasons I voted for eliminating education and outside activities on trustees' resumes was because I feel we are lionizing the candidates . . ."

"The reason for asking for professional background of a general service trustee-at-large (Dr. Norris explained) is to try to balance between metropolitan New York experience and that which might exist in other parts of the country. Our Board needs, for its efficient operation, sometimes good legal advice, the best of public information experience, etc. It isn't in any way to reduce the importance of A.A. capacity, A.A. conscientiousness, A.A. depth. Hopefully we get both . . ."

"I learn an awful lot from people coming and asking me questions (Dr. Dancey). I more often learn more from them than they learn from me. I don't feel important, but just like an A.A. member who has the privilege of coming to these meetings . . ."

"I don't think that a truly important person gets his head turned by attention. We had a problem in our area when a young priest came into A.A. Before long he was speaking every twenty-four hours all over the area, and he is drunk today. It's sad because he didn't have a chance. The same thing happened when a sixteen-year-old girl came into A.A. and was asked to speak at all meetings just because she was sixteen and beautiful. This is very hard for the new member to accept . . ."

"I definitely feel we should do all we can to stop lionizing people. However, I feel this can be done on an individual basis . . ."

"I don't think we should do anything. Someone once told me, anything to get a person sober. If lionizing works for some, then there is nothing wrong. . ."

"I don't think it's really a question of lionizing. I'm a lawyer and people are always lining up to speak to me, but all they want is some free advice . . ."

"I once heard a man speak who was very much loved and respected by fellow A.A.'s. He asked his friends please not to do this, because it was very difficult to keep his sobriety when they gave him challenges he was not ready to cope with . . ."

"I've been to a few meetings where they have oldtimers who are looked to for advice and final decisions on all affairs. I think if we start to educate our newer members, get more people interested in service, as G.S.R.'s and committee members, we will eliminate this whole problem. . ."

"I think this is a question of sponsorship. I myself am a sponsor of a few 'clergymen' and I always explain to them that they are there for one thing. To stay sober . . ."

World Service Meeting

Significant Event in A.A. History

Report

Undoubtedly the most important event in A.A. history since the first North American General Service Conference twenty years ago, was the first World Service Meeting held in New York, Oct. 9-11, 1969. For three days of concentrated working sessions, the twenty-seven elected delegates from twelve countries and one zone joined with delegates from this General Service Conference to share experience, strength and hope with each other and with Bill, the trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. The theme was "Our Common Welfare."

As I said then to delegates, 'A.A. has grown strong . . . in other areas, only a beginning has been made. But just as each individual stays sober one day at a time, the A.A. movement can grow only a day at a time.'

'Just as other generations will surely need A.A. as we do now, other people — other kinds of people that perhaps we fail to reach now — need A.A., and they may need to find it soon or they may die. So with the help of God, we must pass along our Fellowship — enduring, strong and united. Our common welfare today becomes, in a very real sense, our sober pledge to the future. It is no accident that our First Tradition begins with the words "Our common welfare . . ." If our common welfare does not come first, we will join in the chaos and conflicts of our times and our A.A. program might well fail.'

To underscore the First Tradition, one delegate from each country or region was called on to recite the First Tradition in his native tongue: "Our common welfare should come first. Personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity."

Much of the discussion during workshops and questions asked were based on interpretations, and in some cases, misinterpretations, of the Twelve Traditions.

After three days of reports and sharing, the delegates at the final session of the World Service meeting considered six points regarding the future of the meeting. At this time, however, it was noted that the delegates could only voice their opinions on these matters. Final approval must come from the General Service Boards and officers to which they are responsible.

We would like to present the Advisory Actions to this 20th North American General Service Conference for your consideration:

1. Delegates unanimously agreed that the first World Service meeting was worthwhile, and approved the idea of holding future meetings.
2. A large majority approved having the next meeting in three years, although some were in favor of two or four years.
3. Delegates were in substantial agreement that expenses of the next meeting should be shared on a more equitable basis, if possible.

(cont'd p. 24)

TOTAL INVOLVEMENT IN W.S.M.

You all know that wonderful feeling when an event you have anticipated turns out to be beyond your wildest expectation? That's the way we all felt about the 3-day World Service Meeting, held at the Hotel Roosevelt, beginning, Oct. 8, 1969.

The preparations for this meeting were detailed and involved many people; there was total involvement of everyone on the "18th floor" and this involvement extended to all countries participating. These delegates prepared reports concerning their structure, finance, publishing, services, and general service boards. We here at G.S.O. told how we handled these subjects, then a delegate from each country reported how they were handled in this country.

These were real international sharing sessions and it was particularly exciting, for example, to hear a delegate from a well-organized country offer helpful suggestions to a struggling one, or a delegate from a Spanish-speaking country share experience with a delegate from France — in Spanish!

After each session, small, round-table workshops were held; questions asked and answered across the tables—every phase of our operations was explained in detail. All this information, their reports and ours, has been collected into one volume, the most comprehensive information on A.A. worldwide ever assembled.

At the October meeting of A.A. World Services, delegates' names were drawn by lot for four committees: policy, finance, admission/agenda and literature. Already, communications, understanding, and unity have improved immeasurably.

—Midge M.
Secretary, World Service Meeting

WE HAVE MUCH TO SHARE

Prior to the beginning of the first World Service Meeting, I was met in the lobby of the Roosevelt Hotel by many World Service delegates. I came to realize that the "language of the heart" exists worldwide, because right away I detected and acquainted myself with friends I have never met. These delegates were ambitious and anxious to find out all that they could about this wonderful Fellowship.

After the meeting started, we were broken up into small groups which formulated workshops. Here is where a desire for knowledge came about; each session seemed to become more interesting as we went along. Not a single moment was wasted. Luckily, the delegates from North America could be grateful for our longer experience because we had so much to share. But all the delegates were anxious to have our experience as to how we in General Service arrived at suggested guides to protect all of our members and to keep A.A. alive constructively with continuous growth. "A.A. came of age" again at the World Service Meeting.

Charles D., Cen. Michigan

Area Highlights

ALASKA — There are comparatively few groups spread out over vast areas in Alaska, but somehow we all manage to keep in touch and to help each other gain and maintain sobriety. The result is that A.A. continues to grow, and we are beginning to reach out to the Indians and Eskimos who need A.A. as much as the rest of us. —*Pat M.*

ALBERTA — There currently seems to be a sense of unity and striving towards our common welfare and purpose in Alberta. Our provincial government is doing much to coordinate the workings of its various departments which are interested in alcoholism and as their plans are formulated we will be called on for more cooperation. —*Bill W.*

ARIZONA — There is a sense of "something happening" in Arizona, a realization that A.A. has truly come of age and is responsible to the suffering alcoholic. There is a recognition of the need to serve in newer and better ways; the need for more qualified workers and a leadership that can lead, through the seldom discussed Concepts that have been supporting us without us knowing it. —*Betty H.*

CALIFORNIA (Northern Interior) — One thing that may be used to overcome the problems involved in sponsorship, lack of communications, and willingness to serve, is a service meeting which furnishes newcomers and others with the mechanics and history of the different areas of service and thus generates more enthusiasm to serve. —*Ralph W.*

CALIFORNIA (San Diego) — It must be a matter of some concern to note a growing sense of "virtue" at group levels so that they become "showcases of recovered drunks," rather than "havens of hope" for the still suffering. We must remember as groups as well as individuals that if we are to keep what we have, we must give it away. —*Hal C.*

CALIFORNIA (Southern Coastal) — Our annual Symposium of Service featured workshops, presentations and questions as well as a trial before judge and jury of the First Step on the charge that it was no longer appropriate to our times. While the verdict of acquittal surprised no one, the arguing of the case stimulated thought at the same time it tickled ribs. —*Ellery S.*

DELAWARE — Our first Detox Center is in operation in Metropolitan Wilmington, headed by a nonalcoholic who has asked for help from A.A. in sponsoring patients after their five-day stay. Through this we hope to reach more alcoholics, get more people involved and achieve increased unity in our area. —*Lambert S.*

GEORGIA — A.A. in Georgia has come a long way and is growing rapidly. The ink on an area meeting card is hardly dry before we add a new group, and these new groups mean that many new members are accepting the A.A. way of life. Our state assembly has also grown, but not to the degree we feel necessary to meet A.A.'s worldwide needs today. There is much important work to do and we are setting out to do it. —*Bob R.*

IDAHO — Our last state meeting created a new responsibility called the State Reporter. Our State Reporter publishes a monthly news letter which is sent to groups throughout the state. Groups and area committeemen are responsible for channeling items of information to the reporter in order to in-

crease communications and unity throughout the state. Response has been tremendous. —*Edith S.*

ILLINOIS (Northern) — I firmly believe that anyone who wants to do anything about his drinking problem will have no trouble finding an A.A. meeting in our area. They can learn to walk down the street with heads high, to get back in respectable society and feel good inside through the A.A. way of life. It will work for them as it worked for me — one day at a time. —*Roland C.*

INDIANA (Southern) — In Evansville we started a court program in July 1969 in which drinkers are given suspended sentences if they attend Court School for six months. This is just like an A.A. meeting except that there is no prayer or collection. Since it started drunk cases in city court have been reduced by almost half. —*Sam F.*

KANSAS — The redistricting of the Kansas area has become a reality, after two years of asking the group G.S.R.'s and committee members to present their ideas. The area is divided into twenty-two districts with a committee member from each district. Since the plan has recently been put into effect, it is yet to be seen whether it will accomplish our purpose. —*George B.*

KENTUCKY — There seems to be an abundance of interest concerning A.A. service responsibility and service, with concentrated effort to encourage and improve communications with institutional members. We are trying particularly to establish planned sponsorship activities for those being released by putting them in contact with interested outside members. —*Bud W.*

MAINE — All our groups are doing well; many are celebrating their anniversaries. We have a committee trying to get a Maine Roundup organized, but this is only in the planning stage presently. —*Willard F.*

MANITOBA — In the last few years the Conference area of Manitoba has been reorganized to operate strictly within the suggestions of the Third Legacy Manual. The province is divided into ten areas and each area is served by a committee member. We hold four regular meetings each year which has helped increase interest in General Service work. —*Terry P.*

MARYLAND — During the past two years A.A.'s from all over our state have worked to rebuild unity and get in motion. Due primarily to following the Third Legacy Manual our officers have become a truly functioning part of A.A., our first statewide convention is being planned, quarterly newsletters are almost a reality, and a statewide public information committee is beginning to function. —*John O'K.*

MASSACHUSETTS (Western) — We are now planning our first Western Massachusetts A.A. Roundup, geared to make us all feel more excited about sharing our sobriety through service. Secondly, there has been a great deal of activity in the field of cooperation with outside agencies, with many individual A.A.'s not only involved, but aware of the need to safeguard our traditions. —*Marge C.*

Area Highlights

MICHIGAN (Western) — Our area intergroup meets once each month with different cities acting as host. While open to all members it is primarily for G.S.R.'s who are there to discuss business at hand, finances, and area problems, as well as to exchange new ideas and take action on new service programs. It is followed by an opening meeting. —*Floyd D'A.*

MINNESOTA (Northern) — Our round robin meetings are very successful. An open meeting is held each month giving both alcoholics and the public a chance to learn more about the illness of alcoholism and the help that A.A. offers. A banquet is held once a year, with the profit going to G.S.O. to help start new groups. —*Clarence B.*

MISSISSIPPI — A.A.'s who sponsor ex-inmates have developed a program which is designed to accomplish three things — interest the inmate in the A.A. program; teach him the fundamental principles of A.A., and interest him in following it up when released from the institution by offering him the help of people who really care for his future. —*R.T.D.*

MONTANA — Work with Indians has grown tremendously of late with counseling made available on the reservations. Work is also being done on following up patients leaving our state Alcoholic Treatment Center so that they are introduced to A.A. and helped to maintain their sobriety, while many members work with the members in prisons and other institutions. —*Ray R.*

NEBRASKA — Service, the Heart of A.A., "but service without sovereignty," must be our goal. To achieve this end we have as a guide our literature, the mottos and our rich history of shared experience, strength and hope. In this way the path may be wide and smooth and available to all for as long as it is needed. —*Ralph F.*

NEW BRUNSWICK/PRINCE EDWARD ISLAND — Today there are 17 groups with a membership of about 400 on Prince Edward Island. At recent N.B./P.E.I. Roundup we had 550 present at our banquet, showing the growth of A.A. and the fact that the more people are involved in something of this kind, the more unity there is. —*Stan B.*

NEW HAMPSHIRE — G.S.R.'s, along with other interested A.A. members meet monthly, with an average of 70% voting membership in attendance. Our annual dinner for past delegates attracts more than 100 and helps make important strides in A.A. unity, as do our annual conferences. We are currently seeking better ways to bring the A.A. message to the State Hospital and State Prison. —*Helen S.*

NEW JERSEY (Southern) — There are presently 55 A.A. groups in our area which is divided into four districts, and we are striving to better advise groups as to their responsibility and to help make "Service the Heart of A.A." not only a theme but a reality. At the same time we are working to increase our support of the General Service Office. —*John M.*

NEW MEXICO — Institutional work in our area is going forward at a good pace. Last year at the state convention a resident was released to speak on the institutional panel. He was also allowed to attend the dinner and hear the guest speaker. We have good cooperation with the state penal system and

members of the honor farm are now allowed to attend outside meetings. —*Jim D.*

NEW YORK (Hudson-Mohawk-Berkshire) — We are hoping to improve our financial support of A.A. World Services as a result of talks to individual groups many of which, due to regular collections, high individual contributions and low operating costs, have a surplus in their treasuries. There is a need for education of these groups as to what constitutes service. —*Bob W.*

NEW YORK (Western) — Public Information Committee activities have grown rapidly in the past year because of regular monthly meetings, good leadership and the result of several classes with an instructor using the PIC Kit as a guide. All committeemen are members of PIC and they select and screen speakers who attend the school. —*James C.*

NORTH DAKOTA — All groups in the area are providing exceptional service, primarily for the benefit of their own members. Regular visits are made to the two groups at the state penal institution and groups throughout the state have cooperated in a visitation program for the two treatment centers. This requires up to 250 miles of travel, one way, in some cases. —*Arnold J.*

OHIO (Northwest) & MICHIGAN (Southeast) — It is a heartwarming experience to see the cooperation between the members of A.A. and the city officials in carrying the message to the many people who are in trouble because of alcohol. They are given aid and comfort to the fullest possible extent and through the language of the heart, we are carrying the message throughout all this area. —*Charles W.*

OHIO (Southwest) & KENTUCKY (Northern) — Communications between committee, G.S.R.'s and groups seems to be the key to our success and is best attained through committee and general assembly meetings where we can discuss General Service, decide area matters and plan area activity. We also hold two area meetings annually which are open to the public. —*Luke B.*

ONTARIO (Western) — Service, or performance of labor for another, is something to think about. I have caught myself many times spouting off a few minutes and thinking that I have performed service. Now I try to think about the new man, who is confused, sick and shaking. He needs more than words during the first few days. He needs very close service. —*Gil W.*

OREGON — We are fortunate in having members who truly believe in service as a way of life. They have built a good functioning and functional state committee. There is an active public information committee, excellent A.A. services to hospitals and institutions and our A.A. newsletter has led to added interest in service beyond the group level. —*Betty V.*

PUERTO RICO — On this occasion I can't help but remember so many of my good friends who have died of alcoholism. And I am reminded that A.A. does not exist in a vacuum, but is a part of a living society. In Puerto Rico, we have thirty-two groups, and last month I visited nearly all of them. I noticed more and more desire to work together; we try harder to help each other. I hope that God continues to spread His Grace on us so that we continue to help other people who are still suffering from this sickness. —*Raul P.*

Area Highlights

QUEBEC (Southwest – French-Speaking) – During the past few years we have had members assigned to the Montreal Municipal Court. If a person appears to have an alcoholic problem he receives counsel, literature and a meeting list. Meetings are also held on a regular basis in hospitals, clinics and penitentiaries, and we cooperate with the other alcoholism agencies.

–Henri C.

QUEBEC (Southwest – English-Speaking) – Our P.I. Committee is very active in carrying the message to hospitals, schools, medical practitioners, business and churches and other organizations. We have recently started a family night, where separate meetings for A.A.'s, Al-Anons and Alateens are held at the same time, then followed by a type of family social.

–Michael H.

RHODE ISLAND – We are now getting more referrals from other agencies and thus are in the process of establishing more beginners' meetings in our area. Our services have been extended to a greater degree to family court which handles divorce, separation and juvenile cases. Almost half of these cases had an incidence of problem drinking. We are also establishing a program with the criminal courts.

–Joe F.

SASKATCHEWAN – It is my experience that our legacy of service is most vital, yet misunderstood. This means continuous work for those who are interested. I feel we need active participation from our outgoing delegates, committee members and G.S.R.'s so the cycle of learning will continue and eventually more and more A.A. members will become interested in our G.S.O. and World Services.

–Karl F.

SOUTH CAROLINA – Our 73 groups are being divided into five areas and we are planning our first G.S.R. Workshop. This will be helpful in giving G.S.R.'s a better understanding of the duties that are necessary for more Unity and Service in the Fellowship. We are also adopting the Birthday Plan at a state level.

–Cecil H.

SOUTH DAKOTA – A.A. in South Dakota is progressing very well. We have two state conferences a year, one of which is in May and gives the delegate a chance to give his report while it is still fresh in his mind. Our institutional committees are functioning very well in hospitals and penitentiaries and we now have three half-way houses operating within the state.

–Chuck L.

TEXAS (Northwest) – We have started a monthly area newsletter to improve communications and help make each group aware of its neighbors in A.A., to share experiences at the group level so each may reach more alcoholics in their area and help younger and smaller groups survive. Our goal is to help the entire area become aware that "Service is the Heart of A.A."

–Tom O'N.

TEXAS (Southwest) – Each year we hold several pre-G.S.O. workshops so the delegate will have a complete and up-to-date report on activities and be aware where there is trouble, what the problem is and what effort is being made to arrive at a solution. These are sharing sessions and much benefit is derived from all of the groups.

–Doris C.

TENNESSEE – We are a long state— 650 miles, to be exact – and for many years not much organization. We had to get our own house in order to be able to expand our services. We started with our state assembly and worked our way outward to the groups. We now have working Institutional and Hospital Committees – four hospital, seven penal. Our state assembly meets twice a year and we expect to grow stronger as time goes on.

–Walter H.

VERMONT – It is impressed on each group staging a meeting at a Vermont State Hospital to get the name and address of any inmate being discharged within a ten-day period of the date of the meeting so they can make contact with the group nearest to his home. He is then contacted directly and invited to a meeting. In many cases transportation is furnished and a close check kept on his progress.

–Roy C.

WISCONSIN (Northern Wisconsin & Upper Michigan) – In our area the members of A.A. have truly adopted the Responsibility pledge. Many new groups have been formed in the past year which to me means that there is a continuing dedicated service by all A.A. members.

–Stanley P.

WYOMING – Though our state is low in the numbers of A.A.'s, they are very active and dedicated. Our intergroup meetings are very good and we are planning more of them. Local groups are doing a good job of seeing to the needs of A.A. in our state institutions.

–Herman F.

WORLD SERVICE MEETING (from p. 21)

4. New York was unanimous choice for the site of the next meeting, although it was agreed that future meetings should be held in other areas of the world when it becomes feasible.
5. The principle of rotation regarding election of delegates to future meetings was accepted. However, it was noted that each country will determine the method of election or appointment of its own delegates. It was suggested that new delegates might be elected on a staggered rotation basis.
6. Delegates agreed to the formation of four committees to conduct business of the World Service Meeting until the next gathering. These were: Policy, Finance, Agenda-Admissions and Literature-Publishing. Delegates agreed that members for these committees would be chosen by lot.

The whole experience of the meeting was an almost unbelievable example of A.A. unity to me. This was exemplified in a small way on Sunday morning when Dr. Dancy and I had breakfast in my room with the two non-A.A. trustees from other General Service Boards; Mr. Andries Van Staen, chairman of the General Service Board of Belgium and Dr. Walter Lechler, member of the German General Service Board. As we shared our enthusiasm and love for A.A., as we discussed our roles as non-A.A. trustees, we shared our experience and the unity which comes from dedication to our common welfare.

– John L. Norris, chairman
General Service Board of A.A.

G.S.O. Activities Increases

As a membership corporation, a subsidiary of the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc. prepares and controls the G.S.O. operating budget, publishes and distributes all Conference-approved literature, and is responsible for the employment of all G.S.O. personnel. Currently, there are 43 full-time employees and nine part-time (not including Grapevine personnel.)

The year 1969 saw a substantial increase in sales of books and pamphlets over 1968. Total sales for the year were \$477,000, an increase of 10.4%. This increase serves as a weathervane for the growth of A.A.W.S. As you can see, the publishing operation carried its share of overhead and was able to contribute \$85,000 to the General Fund, helping support other services not yet met by group contributors. Free distribution of 186,740 pieces of literature with inventory value of \$6,530 was authorized by A.A.W.S. in 1969, and used to service new groups, to acquaint the public with A.A. as a part of our information service. We continue our practice of pricing foreign-language literature to meet the needs of low-economy countries.

Accounting: This department, under the direction of Charlie Columbia, has six full-time employees, each responsible for a particular function, although each has the versatility to adapt to the other functions whenever necessary. This department has the responsibility for keeping and maintaining proper general books of account and other requirements consistent to standard accounting procedures.

During 1969, this department was responsible for processing and recording over 14,300 orders, total dollar value \$472,700; processing, recording and acknowledging 18,300 contributions totaling \$397,100. This year, the department has acknowledged receipt of over 6,000 1970 Convention registrations and processed more than 2,000 housing requests.

Clerical/Steno: This department, supervised by Madeline Whitlock, like all other departments at G.S.O. is an extremely busy one. There are thirteen full-time employees and one part-time. Seven girls handle transcription of correspondence, take minutes of meetings, cut stencils, etc. The file unit is made up of three girls, who also do research on group histories and maintain G.S.O.'s archives. The balance of this department includes our receptionist, switchboard operator and clerk typist.

Records: Supervised by Rose Failla and her able assistant Connie Sigona, this department hit a new high this year. It processed over 11,000 pieces of mail and from it set up 1,725 new groups, an increase of 100 over 1968. In addition, 9,900 changes of addresses and other group information record changes were made.

Shipping: 1969 was a year of greatly increased activity. Al Cryan supervises six full-time and 8 part-time employees. Last year this department handled 92,747 pieces of incoming mail and sent out 375,000 pieces (including bulletin mailings). Book and pamphlet orders accounted for 63,665 packages shipped to all parts of the world.

Nell Wing, besides serving as Bill's secretary, supervises production of three editions (English, French and Spanish) of G.S.O.'s exchange bulletin *Box 4-5-9*. She also has other editing and styling responsibilities, including production of the Conference *Box 4-5-9* and *Conference Report*.

— Bob H., Chairman
A.A. World Services, Inc.

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED – 1969

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	48,197
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition)	16,173
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition)	5,876
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	6,091
A.A. Way of Life	12,250
Alcoholics Anonymous – Spanish Edition	1,243
Total	<u>89,830</u>

PAMPHLETS

This Is A.A.	156,809
A.A. – 44 Questions and Answers	132,628
Is A.A. For You?	180,073
Young People and A.A.	66,576
A.A. for the Woman New Edition	67,020
Alcoholism The Illness	81,980
The Alcoholic Husband	91,841
The Alcoholic Wife	62,493
Memo to an Inmate	26,294
Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic	81,547
The Jack Alexander Article – About A.A.	49,745
The Fortune Story about A.A.	39,726
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	50,618
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	42,453
What Happened to Joe	86,041
It Happened to Alice	56,830
The A.A. Group	30,089
A.A. Tradition – How it Developed	21,435
Inside A.A.	25,319
The G.S.R.	26,588
The Third Legacy Manual & Twelve Concepts	858
A.A. and the Medical Profession	35,139
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	32,295
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	30,170
A.A. In Prisons	14,394
A.A. In Hospitals	17,213
The Fellowship of A.A.	59,671
A.A. In Your Community	110,511
Foreign Translations	66,147
The A.A. Service Manual (New)	5,917
Twelve Concepts for World Service	336
Total	<u>1,748,756</u>

MISCELLANEOUS

Tapes of A.A. Talks	383
Wallet Cards – 2 Fold	363,342
Wallet Cards – “I Am Responsible”	67,219
Parchment Scrolls	2,622
How It Works	77,878
Newcomers' Meeting Kit	845
Group Handbook	1,763

OTHER SERVICES FILL EXPRESSED NEEDS

The services provided by your General Service Office have come about through expressed needs and fall naturally under certain headings. They include:

1. **Service to New Groups.** Each new group is placed on the mailing list, written, and sent a package of Conference-approved A.A. literature at no charge.
2. **World Directory, Parts I & II.** Prepared annually, a free copy is sent to all on mailing list and all groups. Additional copies are available for sale to A.A. members only.
3. **Box 4-5-9.** Published bimonthly in English, French and Spanish. Other service bulletins for specific services include Loners, Institutions, Public Information, Internationalists (seamen) and a quarterly report from the Board of Trustees.
4. **Group Correspondence.** Sharing group problems and solutions. Contact with groups in hospitals and prisons—hospital and prison directories—Institutional Committees. Correspondence with, and literature for, groups overseas.
5. **Work with Loners and Internationalists.**
6. **Publishing and distribution** of all Conference-approved books and pamphlets.
7. **Help to central offices and intergroups.**
8. **Coordination of program and arrangements** for the annual North American General Service Conference meeting and Conference activity between meetings.
9. **Direction of International Conventions** every five years.
10. **Working with the press, with broadcasting, films** and with area and local P.I. Committees. Cooperation with outside agencies and professional persons interested in A.A.
11. **Preparation of guidelines** sharing specific A.A. service experience.
12. **Tapes and films. Braille books** for blind A.A. members.

New services are added as the need arises, and as approval and finances warrant. Services are discontinued when no longer necessary. Service is the heart of A.A. and our lifeline.

—Hazel R.
Service Coordinator

A.A. PROGRAM WORKS REGARDLESS OF BOUNDARIES

It did not take long for A.A. to arrive in countries outside the U.S. and as letters in all languages began to arrive at G.S.O., we became aware that the program could work for an alcoholic, regardless of nationality, culture, or language.

Almost immediately there was need for translations of A.A. literature as people who found sobriety in this country moved to foreign lands and started A.A. groups. When publishing started in other than English-speaking countries, we found it necessary to set up some kind of translation procedure. At one time, we had sixteen different versions of the Steps in Spanish,

but after working with a committee and in close contact with the General Service Office in Colombia, we now have the Steps and Traditions in a Spanish that is not of any one locality but can be understood by all Spanish-speaking people.

The Big Book has been translated into Afrikaans, French, Finnish, Flemish, German, Norwegian, Spanish, and recently, into Portuguese. In some languages only the first eleven chapters have been published; in others, it is a composite of the Big Book, "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," and "A.A. Comes of Age." A large portion of the pamphlets have been translated into French, Finnish, and Spanish, and the basic ones are available in most languages.

Another way of communicating is through correspondence. In the letters we receive we learn the needs of members and groups. One of our greatest satisfactions is to be able to give information when needed and to be able to put members in touch with one another.

The growth of A.A. has been different in every country. Sometimes, due to the great enthusiasm and leadership qualities of the early A.A. members, it has grown very rapidly. In others this has not been so, and G.S.O. has helped directly, as in Italy. Seeing that there was not much A.A. activity in this country, we translated into Italian the basic pamphlets. As yet not too much A.A. activity seems to have taken place. However, we followed the same procedure with Brazil and now there are about 3,000 members in this country.

In A.A. around the world there is a need for more unity within the Fellowship. The disunity is often caused by the lack of information and knowledge of all the experiences that brought about our Traditions. Self-support and non-affiliation are just two of the often misunderstood Traditions. Our answer to letters is based much more on the Traditions than any other part of the A.A. program.

Many of our services have been taken over by the overseas General Service Offices and this is good, but we still share our experience not only with the offices but with groups in more than 90 countries around the world. As a matter of fact, the overseas correspondence is a full-time assignment for two staff members.

— Mary Ellen U., Overseas

BILL OUTLINES 12 TRADITIONS

Delegates to the Conference viewed a new film in which Bill outlined the history and development of the Twelve Traditions, describing the circumstances arising in the early days of A.A. which demonstrated the need for guidelines by which A.A. could survive as a fellowship, just as A.A. members following the Twelve Steps can survive as individuals.

The hour-long film will be made available to groups on a rental basis, following its "premiere" at the International Convention in Miami Beach, July 3-5, 1970.

ANSWERING LETTERS MOST IMPORTANT SERVICE

Correspondence—answering letters—is our most important service and is the main responsibility of the eight staff members at G.S.O. Thus, we share experience with groups, individual A.A.'s, and nonalcoholics from around the world. The following aids help us in answering correspondence:

1. **The Steps and Traditions** are always kept in mind.
2. **Staff Meetings:** the staff and GV meet weekly to share experience, discuss problems that come in mail, etc.
3. **Visitors:** approximately a thousand visitors from around the world share A.A. information in their areas.
4. **Subject Files:** we maintain a separate folder for each Tradition; also "group experience" folders containing letters about A.A. problems and how solved.
5. **Trustees' Policy Committee:** if the problem is new concerning A.A. policy, it is discussed by the G.S.B. Policy Committee.
6. **General Service Board:** if the problem was not settled by the Policy Committee and seems to need Board action, it is recommended to the Board.
7. **General Service Conference:** problems or subjects may be taken to the Conference for discussion and action.

Staff Coordinator: She serves as (1) assistant secretary of the G.S.B., (2) secretary of the Trustees' Policy Committee and the committee on Conference Policy, and (3) is one of the directors of A.A.W.S. The staff coordinator is responsible for daily staff coverage of the office. She reads and distributes the mail each day and is responsible for maintaining the flow of correspondence, i.e., she checks with the staff to see if help is needed in answering their mail, as we sometimes get behind with this activity when working on special projects.

—Waneta N.
Staff Coordinator

PLANNING FOR CONFERENCE

The actual planning for the annual meeting of the North American General Service Conference is done by the Conference secretary in conjunction with and subject to the approval of the general manager, who is vice chairman of the Conference. Suggestions for the agenda start with the current Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee when they meet at Conference time. Throughout the year the Conference secretary is in touch with this committee and presents all subjects suggested for the agenda to the committee for its approval.

There are nine Conference committees: Agenda/Admissions; Conference Report and Charter; Finance; Grapevine; Institutions; Literature; Public Information; Conference Policy, and

Conference Committee on Trustees. Every delegate serves on a Conference committee. There are ten members to a committee, made up of first-year and second-year delegates.

The committees play a vital part in the health and growth of A.A. For example, the Literature Committee, in conjunction with the General Service Board Literature Committee, is responsible for the development of A.A. pamphlets and books. It is through these committees that the Conference-approved literature is compiled, and they are responsible for seeing that A.A. thinking as a whole is reflected in each pamphlet and book.

It is also important to know that the Conference action taken in any one Conference is not binding on future Conferences. The General Service Conference, guided by a set of principles, or charter, confirmed by the movement in 1955, is the overall *voice of A.A.* The experience of previous Conferences has demonstrated that the Conference truly is not a governing or a legislative body. Instead, it is a service group which in its actions, even lack of action, faithfully reflects the collective conscience of the movement itself.

—Beth K.
Conference Secretary

TRAINING FOR STAFF

The first thing on my training program was a tour of the office. As you can imagine, it's a very busy place. It is the hub of A.A. activities, and is much bigger than most A.A.'s expect. The spirit of A.A. is everywhere, in the hearts of the nonalcoholic people as well as in A.A.'s.

Next, my indoctrination included a short visit with each staff member who explained her job and her responsibilities. We have a biweekly staff meeting, and our regular A.A. meeting is every Friday morning at 11:15. All the staff members have a dictating machine, and I was presented with one, too. I received instructions as how to use it and spend much time practicing. I even wrote some of the Loners, telling them I was practicing on the dictating machine while writing them! I am very proud to report the formation of a new group known as "Top of the World," started by two Loners on Ellsmere Island near the North Pole.

For six weeks, I reviewed the incoming mail with the staff coordinator. Requests for help come from individuals, groups, and intergroup offices all over the world. Group problems and solutions are shared, special help is given to new groups, to groups in hospitals, prisons and A.A. overseas.

As a special project, along with my training period, I have been chairman of the Conference Hospitality Committee, and it has given me great pleasure to arrange the weeks' activities for you and your families.

My first assignment is to correspond with Loners, sponsors of Loners and Internationalists.

—Eleanor N., Staff member

P.I. OBJECTIVES

Objectives of Public Information Service: The primary purpose of A.A. Public Information is the same as the purpose of all A.A. activity—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Until an alcoholic comes to A.A. for help, he himself is still a member of the public—and so that vast body called “the public” is where the alcoholic is. Also, out there are the other people who try in a variety of ways to help the alcoholic—the wife or husband, the doctor, the clergyman, the employer, the lawyer, the policeman, the social worker, etc.

So, our first objective in trying to keep the public informed about A.A. is to reach the alcoholic and those people who influence him. We go about providing this information in several different ways. We try to do it through the news media—newspapers, magazines, radio, and television. We try to carry the message to professional groups, made up of doctors, clergymen, educators, health, welfare, and alcoholism agencies, hospital and rehabilitation facility administrators, law-enforcement people, such as judges, policemen, prison and jail administrators. We try to provide information for community organizations, such as churches, schools, clubs, and libraries and inform these groups that A.A. members are available and willing to to speak at their meetings. We also have material which is directed toward industry and explains how A.A. can help in the recovery of problem-drinking employees.

Ways and Means: The ways and means that we use to reach these various groups are through our pamphlets, especially “A.A. and the Medical Profession,” “A Clergyman Asks About A.A.,” “A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee” and “Alcoholism Is A Management Problem. . . A.A. Suggests One Solution.” For the news media, we have background stories for newspapers, suggested scripts for radio and TV, public-service announcements for radio and TV. We have samples of press releases for special events, such as group anniversaries, banquets, conventions, and the formation of new groups. —Cora Louise B. Public Information

HELP FOR LONERS

Today there are 500 Loners around the world. About 150 of these are in the U.S. and Canada. There are also thirty-nine Spanish-speaking and fifteen French-speaking Lone members. The balance is scattered all around the world, and in a few countries lone members are the only A.A. contacts available.

A Lone member is one who, by reason of his location, is unable to attend A.A. meetings. Through correspondence and A.A. literature he stays sober. Many Loners have never had an opportunity to attend an A.A. meeting.

New Loners receive a letter from G.S.O. and suggestions based on the shared experience of other Lone members. They also receive some A.A. literature, the *World Directories*, and

are put on the G.S.O. mailing list for *Box 4-5-9* and the *Loners Meeting*. This latter publication is mailed every other month and is a 5-page mimeographed letter-type bulletin, made up of excerpts from Loner letters received at G.S.O. Loners outside the U.S. and Canada are put in touch with their own General Service Board or whatever service entity there is in their country.

Loner sponsors play an important role in the sobriety of Lone members. These sponsors are A.A.'s who belong to local groups, but also enjoy writing letters and enhance their own sobriety through this type of Twelfth Step work. Currently, there are 290 Loner sponsors.

Loners are encouraged to “carry the message” in their communities and we hope that every Lone member becomes the founder of a flourishing group. —Midge M., Loner Service

MANY SERVICES FOR PRISONS AND HOSPITALS

With the help of many A.A.'s and interested nonalcoholics, 895 prison groups with a membership of 33,871 have been formed, along with 742 hospital groups, with a membership of 20,160. To help A.A.'s do the job of carrying the message inside, the following services have been developed:

1. **Service to New Groups.** A complimentary supply of literature is sent to each newly registered hospital, prison and rehabilitation group.

2. **Directories.** Listings of groups in institutions are prepared and mailed annually and tell whether correspondence is allowed with A.A.'s on the outside, with groups in other hospitals or prisons, and whether tape recordings are available.

3. **Tapes and Films.** A tape library has been collected, and five films are distributed at no charge to all groups on request.

4. **Institutional Bulletin.** Sent every four months to all groups, as well as committees.

5. **Literature.** Special discount packages (an assortment of pamphlets at considerable saving) are available to help in providing literature to inside groups without funds to purchase it themselves.

6. **Correspondence.** A large part of the Institutions Service consists of correspondence with individual members, group secretaries, committee chairmen, institutional sponsors, administration personnel, and others who find themselves in a position to help the confined alcoholic.

—Ann M., Institutions

INTERNATIONALISTS BULLETIN

The name "Internationalists" was chosen for our sea-going members by the founder of this service, Captain Jack. Having joined A.A. shortly before he was due to leave on a round-the-world trip, he got in touch with a staff member at G.S.O. and corresponded with her during the entire voyage. He carried the Big Book and other literature with him and tried to carry the message at every port. In time his efforts brought many other seamen to A.A. As a result, a special bulletin to these members was started, *A.A. Internationalists Round Robin*, mailed every two months, consisting of excerpts from letters in which members share their experiences and the ways in which they use the Twelve Steps to stay sober.

Each new member receives complimentary literature, the *World Directory, Parts I and II*, a listing of other members, and latest issues of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Round Robin*. A letter goes out to the new members immediately and correspondence is started with the G.S.O. staff member responsible for this Service. Today, there are 366 members listed.

Another service to seamen is a listing of "A.A. Radio HAAMS," people who are interested in amateur radio. Quite a few members of the group are also radio officers and so are able to keep in touch with one another on a daily basis.

—Ann M., *Internationalists*

SOMETHING TO REMEMBER!

Thursday, July 2, will be the opening day when all pandemonium breaks loose! The registration desk is jammed, but you finally make it, pick up your badge and program, and then to the information desk to check and see if Joe, John or Mary has arrived, and all of a sudden someone yells your name from clear across the room and you're home! The Convention has started and you're part of it.

I am sure that this International Convention will be something that you will treasure and remember for many years. All of the daytime meetings of A.A. will be at the Fontainebleau Hotel (except the Sunday morning meeting, which will be at Convention Hall); Al-Anon at the Eden Roc, which is next door. All the evening meetings will be held in Convention Hall which is less than five miles from the farthest Hotel listed. Transportation by bus, free of charge, will be furnished to and from Convention Hall.

In the evenings, there will be many meetings to attend; all the groups from Miami to Palm Beach are rolling out the red carpets for you, our friends from far and near. That old saying is so true: "In A.A. there are no strangers, only friends who have never met."

—Fred S., *co-chairman*
Convention Host Committee

1970 CONVENTION DRAWS NEAR FOR MIAMI BEACH

A.A.'s 35th International Convention will be held in Miami Beach, Florida, July 3 through 5, 1970.

Though the official opening is on the 3rd, there will be a big dance on Thursday evening, July 2. The night of July 5 promises to be one of real entertainment—a star-studded cast will perform at Miami Beach's famous Convention Hall. The Fontainebleau will be the headquarters hotel for all A.A. activities, workshops, alkathons and daytime panel sessions. Al-Anon and Alateen will use the Eden Roc Hotel, which is next door to the Fontainebleau, as their headquarters. The large evening meetings, July 3 and 4, at which Bill and Lois will speak, and the Sunday morning Spiritual meeting, July 5, will be held at Convention Hall.

Reports on charter flights as far away as Finland and as near as Central America will make this truly an "international" convention.

Continuous Meetings

As it is shaping up, the Convention looks like one A.A. meeting after another. Alkathons will run almost continuously from 8:00 a.m. until 2:00 a.m. The six 1½-hour daily workshops start at 8:30 a.m. And the two-hour daytime panel sessions, at which our non-A.A. friends from various professional fields will speak, are scheduled from 10:30 a.m. and 2:30 p.m.

A welcome cup of coffee will await you at several Hospitality suites, hosted by A.A.'s from different states and provinces. Orange, whether on tie, dress, or jacket, signifies that the wearer is a member of Florida's Host Committee. These busy people are serving on the numerous Host subcommittees, such as Greeters, Information, Registration and Transportation, just to mention a few.

The registration fee is \$6.00 for all Convention session. For an additional \$4.00, you can attend the opening dance and closing show. All housing reservations are handled by the Miami Beach Housing Bureau, a \$15.00 deposit being required for each room. Miami Beach is known for its fine hotels, motels and recreational facilities. Transportation is excellent and for those attending the Conventional Hall meetings, special buses will be available, and your badge will be your fare. (In short, if you are wearing your Convention badge, you ride free!)

Don't miss this opportunity to share A.A., Al-Anon and Alateen with Bill and Lois, along with thousands of other A.A.'s from around the world. There were 3,500 in St. Louis, 8,900 at Long Beach, 10,400 at Toronto. How many will there be at Miami Beach? We don't know, but your guess is as good as ours. Let's make this one of A.A.'s biggest and happiest anniversary ever!

—Robert H.
Convention chairman

GV CIRCULATION 55,000

In 1969, Grapevine's 25th Anniversary of uninterrupted publishing and distribution of the magazine was marked in the June issue with articles and reprints stressing the history of A.A. through the Grapevine years. Readership comment was excellent, and the original printing of 55,000 was quickly exhausted, prompting a reprint order of 5,000.

The July issue, stressing articles and stories by young people in A.A., brought forth enthusiastic expressions of gratitude from young A.A.'s all over the country.

With the advent of the first World Service Meeting in October the Grapevine prepared an issue from manuscripts and letters received during the past two years from all over the world of A.A. in foreign lands.

Currently, a series on the Traditions and on the Twelve Steps is running in alternate months. Interest is reflected in the increase of mail commenting on the usefulness of these articles for Step and Tradition meetings and study groups.

Reader participation has been growing each year, but this past year we have entered an era of reader participation as never before. Response by letter and manuscript to such recent subject pieces as agnosticism, profanity, honesty in job-seeking and the alcohol-pill problem is reflected in the April, May, and June issues. The editors feel this is a gratifying development, for as this kind of real interest in the Grapevine grows within the Fellowship, so will the Grapevine grow.

CIRCULATION:

A substantial increase in subscriptions at 1969 year end brought the circulation to 54,700, as compared with 51,900 in 1968; a 4% increase. During this current quarter the magazine has passed the 55,000 mark and at the end of March stood at 55,762.

The Grapevine Calendar, which was first presented to the Conference in April 1967, has proved to be a favorite with our readers and an order of 15,000 of our 1971 issue is now on the press.

Over the years requests have flowed in for a compilation of humor stories or cartoons from the Grapevine. This year we will present "The Best Cartoons from the Grapevine" at A.A.'s 35th Anniversary and International Convention in Miami.

During the past year, the chairman of our Corporate Board, Ed L., and director Barry L., rotated off the Board. We miss them and are grateful to them for their valuable contributions. Ed was replaced by Ruth W., as president-chairman. Ruth was already a director and officer, as well as trustee on the General Service Board. George G., a member of the Editorial Board, and Ralph A., former delegate, have been recently elected to the Corporate Board as directors. We look forward to working with them in the next few years.

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION

	<u>4/70</u>	<u>4/69</u>
United States	47,382	43,981
Canada	6,661	6,287
U. S. Possessions	120	108
All Foreign	906	825

Increase for the period: 3,868

WORKSHOP (from p. 17)

A.A. Members and Pills

(For further information, anyone can place in the hands of officials or administrators, the pamphlets "A.A. in Hospitals" and "A.A. in Prisons.")

Q. "Can people with all kinds of problems not connected with the illness of alcoholism, such as gamblers, drug addicts, psychotics, overweight people, etc. attend closed meetings?"

A. The consensus was 'no'. Some workshops did, however, add: 'Group autonomy is, of course, considered. Those with other problems are welcome at public or open meetings'.

Q. "Can A.A. help by sharing experience in starting groups similar to A.A., such as Narcotics Anonymous?"

A. Yes. Assist by lending the principles of the A.A. program, but ensure there is no affiliation. It has been noted that this has been done often with a variety of 'self help' organizations, such as Narcotics Anonymous. We could term this as 'sharing experience'. Our co-founder Bill explains that this should be done in his pamphlet, "Problems other than Alcohol."

Q. "Should 'Alcoholic and Pill' groups be listed as A.A. groups when they are formed for people who have the double problem?"

A. No, these groups should not be listed in the *World Directory*, but the information concerning them would be valuable to G.S.O. to have in its files. It was understood by some delegates that some local offices list such groups and, in this case, autonomy does apply; however, most local offices follow G.S.O. policy and Conference actions.

Questions and Answers From the Floor

Q. What about a group in one area wanting to change to another area—i.e., a group now in N.E. Texas area wants to go in with the S.W. area?

A. It is up to the S.W. area assembly if they wish to accept a new group. This has been done in other areas where one group, though belonging to one area, is closer in distance to another.

Q. Please define the duties of an area chairman, and what should his relationship be with the area committee members?

A. This is covered in detail in "The A.A. Service Manual." See Chapter Four.

Q. What can be done in areas that are becoming slums? The old groups are moving out and in many cases are not being replaced.

A. Many delegates expressed the feeling that this was becoming a crucial problem in their areas, and they did not know how to handle it. Members are afraid to go into certain areas and attendance at such meetings has declined. The question was referred to the Agenda/Admissions Committee of the General Service Conference.

Q. Wherever it is used in print why do we not consistently use the term "recovering alcoholic" rather than "recovered alcoholic?"

A. Bob H. explained "This is simply because it was the way it was originally expressed and has not come up before. However, if the delegate wishes to pass this suggestion on to the Literature Committee, they may wish to consider this change whenever a reprint of a pamphlet is needed."

Q. What procedure is used to select the staff for G.S.O. and why are men being discriminated against?

A. Men are not discriminated against. Any man who feels he is qualified for the position has every right to apply; any interested A.A. member is encouraged to apply, as staff openings do occur from time to time. Some general qualifications are: (1) At least four years of continuous sobriety in A.A., (2) A good background in a business or service organization (in or out of A.A.), (3) Experience in speaking at A.A. meetings and (4) Knowledge of a foreign language (particularly Spanish and French) can prove useful, but this is not essential.

Q. Do any other delegates believe there is a market among members, who have been sober awhile, for a pocket-size, hard-cover edition of the Big Book—without the stories? Perhaps selling for \$4.00 or \$4.50?

A. Bob H. said that the A.A.W.S. Board had very carefully considered similar suggestions before. "As you know, the excess income from A.A.W.S. Publishing is necessary to make up the difference between contributions from

groups and the costs of services to groups. Anything that effects sales of the Big Book, 'Alcoholics Anonymous,' has always been a matter of great concern, simply because this is the biggest item in the A.A.W.S. inventory. I would like to suggest that the delegate making this request send in this suggestion, along with his thoughts on why this would be a good thing, and it will then be discussed again."

Q. To what extent can institutions participate in area functions; mainly, what is the thinking of holding conferences in institutions?

A. Some delegates said this was being done to some extent in their areas, noting that it had to be done with the agreement of the warden or administrator, and all rules of the institution had to be followed. Many had held small panels and also many women delegates had attended such meetings. It was the consensus of the Conference that holding such activities within prisons or institutions was good, as long as it was acceptable to the authorities and practicable.

Q. Is New York Intergroup affiliation a prime prerequisite in selection of in-town trustees, staff members, and A.A.W.S. members? Why isn't their General Service work considered?

A. No, affiliation with the New York Intergroup is not a prerequisite. "Although in my opinion," Bob said, "New York Intergroup is an excellent training ground for people interested in such service work. Of course, a candidate's previous service work is considered."

Q. Are ex-officio Conference committee members serving a purpose?

A. Yes, we need their experience and suggestions and some are very active.

Q. Has Bill ever said, "If there was any change he would make in the Big Book, it would be to change the word 'rarely' to 'never' at the start of Chapter Five"?

A. No, Bill said he had never considered this.

Q. Is it the wish of G.S.O. that the delegates act merely as a rubber stamp to approve their actions?

A. Bob H., vice chairman of the Conference, said that he would consider it a personal failure if any delegate felt this way. He said, "You are not rubber stamps, either collectively or individually. If this delegate will speak to me later, I will be more than glad to discuss this with him."

Q. Would you explain Bernard Smith's opinion, referring to responsibility of trustees, as given in the delegate's Information Manual, i.e. "While trustees 'should manifestly be strongly influenced by a recommendation of the Conference,'

(continued)

ASK-IT BASKET

the Board is not legally bound to adopt resolutions in accord with recommendations of the Conference."

A. Bernard explained that there is a legal requirement here. The Board of Alcoholics Anonymous is a membership corporation, formed under the laws of the State of New York, and it must accept certain responsibilities. But, he said, "there is no need to worry, because the Board has always followed the wishes of the Conference. There may be events in the future that would call for incorporation of the Fellowship itself, but I don't envision this in the spirit of A.A." Bob H. then posed the question: "In the Society of A.A., which would you rather have? Legal power or moral authority"? In addition Bill pointed out that the groups themselves have the ultimate power, simply because they can cut off the money supply.

Q. Why not give more publicity to birthday and In Memoriam contributions?

A. They are both carried periodically in *Box 4-5-9*. They are in the new Money folder, but we would appreciate any suggestions as to how to bring this to the attention of groups, and in other ways, too.

Q. Why don't we arrange the Tradition to read "... at the level of press, radio, TV and films"?

A. Much of our literature, as well as "A.A. Comes of Age," does read this way. This Conference could initiate such action if it wishes to do so. It was the consensus that the "film" covered TV, and further, that first the Conference and Board must approve, and then all groups must be polled, and 75% agree in writing to change any wording in the Traditions.

Q. If, as we are told, A.A. and Al-Anon are two separate entities, why are Al-Anon articles written by Al-Anon members, published in the Grapevine?

A. Most of these articles in some way have to do with the alcoholic. How a wife, for instance, learned to cope with her husband's drinking problem, or have some other direct bearing on the program of A.A.

Q. A Texas group says it wrote to G.S.O., but has not received a reply.

A. Let the coordinator have the necessary information and we will research our files. There are several reasons why this may not have been answered. We do want to answer all letters and are grateful for them.

Q. How can we obtain more accurate reporting of number of group members as reported to the *World Directory*?

A. Such records can never be 100% perfect. We would be most grateful if any of you could give us suggestions how to improve the accuracy of our record-keeping. Delegates

might help by impressing on their committee members the necessity of being more careful in reporting.

Q. It has been understood that those who attended the 1969 Southeastern Convention in Chattanooga, Tennessee, were given the privilege of early registration for the International Convention in Miami Beach.

A. Yes, they were given the privilege of registering early. The only benefit they received was that they were able to register earlier. They were given no housing preference.

Q. Do you plan to make a new G.S.O. filmstrip to show the new office in the near future?

A. We do indeed hope, as soon as feasible, to prepare a new filmstrip, including shots of the new office.

Q. If a member has ten or more years' sobriety, is it harder for him to communicate with the new member than when he had only two or three years' sobriety?

A. Show of hands indicated only 16 found it more difficult.

Q. Is there a member to correspond with, who works with an Indian group or has Indian members in the group? What approach is used?

A. There are many delegates who have had experience in working with Indians. They will be happy to share. G.S.O. will provide names.

Q. Because of the rapid change in the value of the dollar, why not increase the amount that can be contributed by an individual to \$500?

A. We are more interested in getting more groups to participate than we are in getting the ones who do to contribute more. This suggestion can be submitted to the Finance Committee if you wish.

Q. Would like some sort of expression of opinion such as show of hands on the following: Should A.A.'s cooperation in an honor court (i.e. the supplying of speakers, literature, interviewing, etc.) be done under an existing area service committee, or should it be the responsibility of a group of A.A.'s independent of existing service structure? If it should be part of present committee structure, where would it best fall? — under public information or institutions?

A. Show of Hands: How many feel this sort of program should be part of public information? None. Institutional Committee? Twelve.

How many feel this program should be the responsibility of a group of A.A.'s who are independent? Show of hands: Fifteen.

Q. Could the directory for institutions be issued to delegates on the same basis as the *World Directory*?

A. Yes, a copy of the new Directory is sent to all delegates every two years. A copy will also be included in the delegates' Conference Kit in the future.

G.S.B. Approves Important Policies

Your General Service Board in recent months has approved policies that will have lasting importance for our Fellowship.

First in importance was our first World Service Meeting. As most of you already know, delegates from twelve foreign countries and one zone met with our own North American delegates in New York last October in what must rank as a truly historic service meeting in which your whole Board participated.

First Trustee-At-Large

Your Board took another historic step when it set the qualifications and background it required for its first general service trustee-at-large. There was a joint meeting on Sunday prior to the opening day of the Conference, of the Trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees. The purpose of that meeting was to reduce the thirty-nine candidates from the several states to just four—as directed by previous Conference action, so you can elect our first general service trustee-at-large.

I talked with several of the participants in Sunday's marathon meeting and without exception they told me this was one of the hardest jobs they had ever had—so very many fine A.A.'s, so many of them eminently qualified for the job.

New Trustees' Committees

Another milestone in strengthening our structure was passed a few months ago with the formation of two new Trustees' Committees.

The first of these will be a long-range planning committee. It will be charged with the responsibility of anticipating the Fellowship's future needs in the context of possible economic and social changes which in the committee's opinion will or may occur.

The second committee will be given the duty of working with outside agencies. That is to say, they will not only co-operate with such government and private groups, within the framework of our Traditions, but they will suggest policies and guidelines to follow in our cooperation for consideration by the Trustees' Policy Committee, the Board, and by the Conference itself.

In the past, this responsibility was borne by the Trustees' P.I. Committee. But that committee is so busy with its primary concern of informing the public that it cannot handle both of these important areas. It seemed to them, and to your Board, that a new committee could take over supervision of our relationships with all "outsiders"—the more so since there are today an ever-increasing number of these other groups, both publicly and privately run.

International Committee Disbanded

I should mention here, too, I think, that the Trustees' International Committee, at its own request, has now been disbanded. It felt and the Board agreed, that the worldwide struc-

ture created by the delegates at the World Service Meeting made further work on their part unnecessary.

I have personally had the opportunity of traveling about the country and visited many A.A.'s and A.A. groups. I have also had the opportunity of getting down here to New York on a number of occasions, in addition to my regular trips to attend our quarterly Board meetings.

I don't have to tell you about our new offices—these you saw for yourselves. There are still a few things to be completed, but I think we're all set up now to meet all anticipated needs.

Bob Morse, Archie Roosevelt Resign

Finally, it is my sad duty to tell you of the resignation of two of our nonalcoholic trustees. Archie Roosevelt, a virtually indispensable trustee ever since 1953, and our treasurer during most of that period, must now leave us. Similarly, Bob Morse, Archie's successor as treasurer, also is leaving us. Both do so with regret; both do so for reasons of health.

—John L. Norris, M.D., Chm.,
General Service Board of A.A.

POLICY

The purpose of the Trustees' Policy Committee, which was formed in April, 1955, is to make recommendations to the General Service Board of A.A. on policy matters affecting A.A. as a whole. The committee reviews all proposals before they go to the Board. This committee provides the balance which gives any point of view a chance to be aired and discussed.

The Policy Committee meets prior to the Board meeting and uses a "Town-hall meeting" format, with from 35-40 present; it provides a wealth of experience to clarify our A.A. thinking and forms the basis for recommendation to the Board. All trustees and directors, and the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs are invited to attend, as are all members of the various Trustees' Committees.

Reports are received from the A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine Boards, the Trustees' Committees, regional trustees and Conference secretary. At the April meeting, just following the Conference, the Conference advisory actions are reviewed by the Policy Committee. Following are some of the recommendations made to the Board during the past year:

1. Media to be advised of the first World Service Meeting.
2. The P.I. Committee be authorized to proceed with a series of "probes" to develop more insight into the public's image of A.A. and to determine whether or not a major survey on the subject is warranted.

(continued)

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POLICY (from p. 33)

3. Travel expenses for A.A. speakers be accepted, when invited to speak to non-A.A. organizations.
4. The revised "Composition, Scope and Procedure" of the Policy Committee be approved.
5. A.A. be listed as a cooperating agency in an information campaign, which will be directed to persons who exert multiple influence in the field, such as doctors, nurses, social workers, clergy, owners of media and community leaders.
6. When federal government agencies, such as the Office of Economic Opportunity, are interested in interviewing A.A.'s as possible counselors for their alcoholism programs, we submit the listing of A.A. central offices, if requested and if appropriate, as a point of contact.

— Maurice R., Chairman

FINANCE & BUDGETARY

Overall the financial picture for 1969 was quite good and it might even be described as satisfactory by some. However, there still is room for improvement. Sales for the year were good, with net sales showing an increase of \$43,642 over 1968 or 10.2% but, unfortunately, the amount carried through to *net income* showed no increase which emphasizes the increased cost of doing business. Contributions totaled \$397,146 for the year, which was \$10,846 more than forecast and \$30,931 more than for 1968. Total income, i.e., publishing gross profit and contributions, increased \$54,056 over 1968, or an increase of 8.6%. Total expenses *excluding* the \$15,000 architect's fee incurred in connection with moving the A.A. office increased by \$41,626 over 1968, which amount was pretty much on target being within 1% of the budgeted amount. I think it is important to note that the share of total expenditures covered by the Group Fund was 67.2% in 1969 which compares with 69.1% in 1968. This, of course, is not favorable and serves to point up the great need for an increase in the contributions received from the groups. Certainly, we cannot expect the publishing business to carry an ever greater portion of the expense total for, if such is to be the case, there will be no alternative but to substantially increase selling prices.

The 1970 G.S.O. budget has been reviewed by the Finance Committee and approved. Higher sales trends are expected to continue and have been budgeted 6.9% higher than in 1969. However, the expenses of the publishing operation have been budgeted 8.7% higher than actual expenses for 1969. Contribution income is expected to increase \$19,954 or 5% more than last year. However, as I indicated before, the contributions are covering a smaller portion of the expense total, and I would hope that the total for 1969 would exceed the 5% increase called for in the budget. All expenses *excluding* the cost of construction and moving which, of course, will be non-recurring have been budgeted 8.1% higher than in 1969 for a total

increase of \$53,755. While the expense trend in these inflationary times is typical, it is nevertheless a matter for concern. I can assure you that those responsible for the management of A.A. affairs are deeply conscious of this problem and will take every measure possible to keep the expense under tight control and the rate of increase more in line with the expected increase in sales. The estimated cost of moving and the estimated cost of constructing new quarters will not be amortized over the life of the new lease but will be charged to 1970 expenses resulting in an overall budget deficit of approximately \$99,000. This sizable deficiency will be covered by tapping A.A.W.S. capital funds, by using any available funds in the General Fund, by using whatever funds may be made available by the Grapevine and to the extent necessary by the tapping of Reserve Funds.

As many of you know this will be my last official duty at Alcoholics Anonymous for I have found it necessary to retire from active participation, not only here but from business as well. In bowing out I simply want to say thanks to all of you for letting me be with you — I hope I have been of some help. It has been a great experience for me, rich and rewarding in many ways — an experience that will forever be a pleasant memory. My best wishes to A.A. and its dedicated staff and to all of you and A.A.'s everywhere, may God bless you.

— Robert W.P. Morse, Chm.,
Trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee

NOMINATING

The Nominating Committee of the General Service Board is made up of representatives of A.A. and non-A.A. trustees and directors of both A.A. World Services, Inc. and the Grapevine, Inc. The committee meets quarterly prior to the meeting of the General Service Board of Trustees. During the past year, the following actions were recommended:

1. That the following slate of officers and directors of the Corporate Board of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. be elected at the annual meeting of the A.A. Grapevine Board in October, subjected to the approval of the amended bylaws of the A.A. Grapevine at the July Board meeting:

Ruth W.	President & Chairman
David B.	Acting Treasurer
Paula P.	Vice President & Secretary
Austin MacCormick)	
Milton Maxwell)	Directors
Jack M.)	
Robert P.)	

2. Approved the recommendation of George G. as a new director to the Grapevine Board.
3. Approved the resumes for presentation of Ralph A. as Grapevine director, Robert M. as A.A.W.S. director and Arthur Miles as non-A.A. trustee to the General Service Board for election.

4. Recommended the following candidates be presented to the General Service Board for election as trustees of the General Service Board at their annual meeting in April after presentation of the candidates to the General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any.

Class A

John L. Norris, M.D.
Travis Dancey, M.D.
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Austin MacCormick
Arthur J. Miles
Hon. John Murtagh
Bernard B. Smith

Class B

Arthur A.
Eric B.
William C.
Rollie D.
Donald F.
Stephen O.
Robert P.
Bayard P.
Katharine P.
John R.
Maurice R.
Ruth W.
Jim H. (G.S. Trustee-at-Large. Elected 4/70)

5. The following officers of the General Service Board were recommended to be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, 1970:

Chairman:	Dr. John L. Norris
First Vice Chairman:	Bernard B. Smith
Second Vice Chairman:	Rollie D.
Treasurer:	Arthur J. Miles
Assistant Treasurer:	Dennis Manders
Secretary:	Arthur A.
Assistant Secretary:	Waneta N.

6. The following were presented as A.A.W.S. directors to be elected at the annual meeting of A.A.W.S., Inc. in April:

Robert H.	Stephen O.
Robert M.	Robert P.
Walter M.	Bayard P.
Waneta N.	

7. The following slate of officers of A.A.W.S. to be elected at the May meeting of A.A.W.S., Inc. was presented:

President:	Robert H.
First Vice President:	Bayard P.
Second Vice President:	Waneta N.
Secretary:	Hazel R.
Treasurer:	Stephen O.

8. Reviewed a proposal from a delegate for a change in the qualifications for a regional trustee candidate to exclude education and outside A.A. activities. The committee did not believe the proposal to be consistent with the best interests of the Fellowship and it was referred to the Conference Committee on Trustees for further consideration at the meeting in April, 1970.

9. Reviewed the suggestion that any delegate shall not be eligible as trustee candidate until a full year after ending his term as area delegate. The committee felt it would be best not to place such a limitation on the eligibility of a regional

trustee candidate. This question was referred to the Conference Committee on Trustees at their meeting in April, 1970.

10. Reviewed the suggestion that the limit of 75 miles be discontinued with regard to location of general service trustee-at-large candidates and agreed that it be referred to the Conference Committee on Trustees in April, 1970.
11. Reviewed the question "Can one who has served as regional trustee be a candidate for general service trustee-at-large?" After due consideration, the committee felt that this would not be advisable.
12. Reviewed again the subject of each Conference area selecting a regional trustee candidate and the committee recommended once more that "a trustee candidate *may* be elected from each Conference area, or that two or more of the Conference areas within a state or province may jointly propose a single candidate." It was referred to the Conference Committee on Trustees for their meeting in April, 1970.
13. The committee reviewed 39 resumes of all general service trustee-at-large candidates from the U.S. and all were found to be eligible for consideration. It was recommended that a rating system be used to evaluate the qualifications of the candidates.

—Robert P., Chairman

PUBLIC INFORMATION

During the past year, the Trustees' Public Information Committee worked in a number of ways to help carry the A.A. message and to extend the hand of A.A. by providing information about the Fellowship to the public. Among the projects of the P.I. Committee were:

- Six P.I. Bulletins, published every other month;
- A one-page article on the 1970 International Convention for the August issue of the A.A. Grapevine;
- The Annual Report to the Public;
- A Press Release on the revised Young People's pamphlet;
- A Press Release on the World Service Meeting; and
- We sent to all delegates the names and addresses of the executive directors of all NAAAP and NCA agencies in their state so that they can get to know these people and offer A.A. cooperation to them.

Also this year the following new projects were completed:

- The Public Information Kits were revised and updated, and new material added, as well as a new kind of packaging;
- A sub-committee of the P.I.C. was formed to work on publicity for the International Convention;
- A set of announcements about the Miami Convention were prepared for the use of group secretaries; and

(continued)

G.S.B. REPORTS

P.I. (from p. 35)

- d. Two pamphlets have been completed in the last year. An introductory folder for industry, "Alcoholism Is A Management Problem . . . A.A. Suggests One Solution," and a description of the A.A. Membership Survey. Both are being distributed.

In the past year, we began several projects which are still in progress:

- a. A public information program about alcoholism, sponsored by the Smithers Foundation, is being directed toward people who are influential in their communities such as doctors, nurses, social workers, clergy and newspaper publishers. A.A. will be listed as a cooperating agency;
- b. We are beginning a mailing to major insurance companies to ascertain the feasibility of mailing the new industry folder to a list of companies whose employees are covered by Workmen's Compensation. Such companies do not have in-house medical departments and therefore, probably no alcoholism programs, and
- c. The P.I.C. is conducting a series of probes to determine the public concepts and misconceptions about A.A. The first two phases of the study have been completed, and the third phase is now in preparation.

— Bayard P., Chairman

LITERATURE

Since the report to the 19th General Service Conference in April, 1969, the Trustees' Literature Committee, with the help and cooperation of the Conference Literature Committee, has completed or is working on the following projects. (Because of the first World Service Meeting, only two meetings of the Committee were held instead of the usual three.)

1. The new version of "Young People and A.A." with new text and stories and lively looking new cover is now in wide distribution. Stories of even younger A.A.'s have been suggested for the next revision.
2. The illustrated Traditions pamphlet has had to be postponed until the fall of 1970.
3. The first draft of the pamphlet, "A.A. in the Armed Services," has been reviewed by the Trustees' Literature Committee and is now being considered by the Conference Literature Committee and a selected number of members and non-members in the armed services before completion.
4. It was agreed that a new story of a young A.A. member be added to the stories in the Big Book and, in addition, that a page be added giving sources in Conference-approved pamphlets for other stories (examples: "A.A. For The Woman" and "Young People In A.A.").

5. Editing is being done on the article "In Resident Physician" for inclusion in the next rerun of "A.A. and the Medical Profession."
6. After approval of the concept of the preparation of a booklet which will contain much practical advice about staying sober, a first draft is now being completed and will be distributed to both Conference and Trustees' Literature Committee members for approval sometime after May 15.
7. Members of both committees have endorsed the reprinting of a paper originally delivered by an A.A. member to a class at the University of California at Los Angeles. As a result, A.A. World Services is clearing final details to enable it to be made available to the Fellowship.
8. As the result of a suggestion received from the Conference Literature Committee, the first draft of a pamphlet on G.S.O. services is being edited and readied for distribution by A.A. World Services, Inc.
9. At the request of the Conference Literature Committee, a questionnaire concerning literature needs was sent to a sampling of A.A. groups and central offices. The evaluation of the replies indicated that, with few exceptions, the groups' needs are being met by Conference-approved books and pamphlets. In addition, there was an enthusiastic response to the proposed booklet, "Come to Believe."
10. Some Al-Anon pamphlets were reviewed to see if there are ideas which they are developing in their literature from which we might learn.
11. There was a discussion of the term "Conference-approved" as it is used to designate literature published by A.A.W.S. because the use of the reverse term "non-Conference-approved" might imply disapproval or censure. It was unanimously voted to continue with the use of the term "Conference-approved."

—Austin MacCormick, Chairman

IN GRATITUDE: TO BOB AND ARCHIE

Robert W. P. Morse, nonalcoholic member of the General Service Board since 1965, announced at the Conference his plan to retire, both from business and as a trustee, for reasons of health. Archibald B. Roosevelt, also a member since 1953, recently retired from the Board also for health reasons.

Archie, former treasurer of the Board and chairman of the Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, has given unstintingly of his time and effort over the years, as has Bob who also served as treasurer of the Board.

For their many contributions and their long and valued friendship, we are indeed grateful.

Speakers Discuss A.A.'s Past and Future

Sometimes I think that I must have more reason for gratitude than anyone in the world. And not the least is the magnificent success of this Conference. As you know, the largest part of my life has been devoted to assisting in its structure and its conduct.

But looking out on you I realize that here is the evidence that A.A. can endure and surmount any obstacle, and this is something which leaves me with a satisfaction for which there are no words I can express.

Each time I stand here on closing day, my mind ranges over the years and the panorama of service that has evolved. I remember the tiny meeting of alcoholics in Akron in 1937 and of visiting Dr. Bob. And the thought came up that we had to make some head and tail of this program. We had the recovery program, but how were we to transmit this message?

Narrow Vote for Foundation

So up came the idea of a foundation. Dr. Bob called a meeting to see how this idea would strike the Fellowship. The vote (by a margin of one) was for the creation of what we were to call the Alcoholic Foundation. And then nonalcoholic friends, the first in a long succession of them, began to take an interest in us. They were the forerunners of a long line of devoted servants. I can compare them with Dr. Silkworth, the little man who loved drunks. And so it must be with all of these great friends, without whom these services could never have existed in their present form.

And then my mind goes on to a few years later when we took on the publication of the Big Book, and again one looks at the scene of confusion and anguish, but also of magnificence. We saw our people at their best and worse, and out of this came the text by which so many of us are alive today, and certainly it must have been God-inspired, because nothing showed we could carry out such a deal.

First Major Publicity

And then came major publicity and the alcoholic and his family began to seek us out in the thousands. In Cleveland we proved that mass production of sobriety was possible. And in the middle of it all, I saw this idea of General Services. Then came the challenge that to my mind was the most serious. True, we had a spiritual formula for recovery. We had seen a transmission in the world around us, bringing us great crowds of alcoholics. Could these people, even though sober, live and work together in unity and harmony?

For ten years, there was a lot of trouble. It is out of this that the A.A. Traditions evolved. You see, Dr. Bob and I had been more or less teachers on the recovery part of the program, but now it was supposedly all of the erratic folks who were teaching us in their wisdom, and we modified our stance accordingly. So the group conscience took shape.

Doctor Bob Stricken

Then in the late forties, Dr. Bob was stricken with an illness which we knew would be fatal, and people began to raise the point that if the oldtimers were perishable, who would be their successors? And how can a group conscience have any bearing upon the Board of Trustees unless there are delegates? Well, this was a very shocking idea to us, and we had reason for concern. And the trustees expressed their feelings, "You don't mean you are going to have 100 delegates come here, telling us what to do? Let's keep it simple." Well, the boat rocked and rocked, but it didn't capsize. And then the Conference emerged and since that time twenty years ago, it has completed every task thrown upon it. And I feel very proud that though we live in the most perilous era that mankind has ever known, our Society will survive under God's will for so long as He may need us. May God bless and keep you now and ever more.

—Bill W.

oOo

SEEKING EMOTIONAL SOBRIETY

I do not feel that I am leaving the General Service Office with the expiration of my term as a director of A.A. World Services. Too much of my A.A. life has been spent there and too many of my A.A. friends work there for me to ever leave. Rather I am rotating into another phase of A.A. activity. What this is remains to be seen, but I know that there is still much to do — for myself in seeking emotional sobriety, as well as in trying to help carry our message to the millions throughout the world who still suffer.

Recently, I have come to believe that for my own sake I must now seek this emotional sobriety, perhaps more earnestly than I once sought physical sobriety; for that was given to me. I feel, too, that there are many like me in A.A. who after years of activity have come to recognize this need for emotional sobriety — and that the dangers are great for those of us who do not try to find it. We stagnate, we drop out of A.A., we get drunk. I believe that this problem faced by "oldtimers" is as serious as any difficulty faced by newcomers, women, young people, minorities or any others in A.A. It may be that some of us do not see that we are in trouble, while many of us who do often try to get out of it by ourselves. It is not so much that we cannot talk about it, but that because of our "seniority" we feel that we should not *have* to talk about it. Nor do we seek out and meet with others in A.A. like ourselves.

However, I think that as the need becomes more apparent we will work together in A.A. to find a way to define and recognize this problem, bring it into the open and find the answer to it — through the Twelve Steps and the practice of these principles in all our affairs.

— Niles P.

Task Force to Review Conference

There has been a lot of listening in the last five days and hopefully you of Panel 20 will be able to see the evidence when you come back next year. You gave us a job to do yesterday, regarding the task force to review procedures and the mechanics of the Conference. My appointments to this committee are as follows: Andy A., chairman; Hazel R., staff member; Marge C., Junior A., Luke B., Pat O'H. and Art K., delegates.

You will be hearing from all of them during the next few months. We plan to have a meeting in Miami and try to review the ideas you give us during the next few weeks so they can be put to work before next year's Conference. We don't want to be told how good it was. It has been a mountain-top experience for all of us. However, most of this world is in the plains and we have to settle back into the plains and meet reality.

To me this has been one of our best Conferences. One of the things that has happened this year to a degree that it hasn't happened before is that we have faced some of the problem areas and have faced them with our differences of opinion.

We have been talking about Service, the Heart of A.A. I would like to substitute the word "life" because heart is too limited. Life is whole and certainly we know that without service we lose our lives. Fifteen years ago in St. Louis Bill presented our Three Legacies. Of the third he said, "We must carry the A.A. message of recovery or we will fall into decay and some of us will die." Service covers all we do to reach the alcoholic, from the ten-cent call to the working of this Conference and the General Service Office.

Yet, many things are different now from twenty years ago, when these Conference meetings began. The climate has changed for many alcoholics, especially for the new young member. He is not quite the outcast he would have been in the early days. He is still a mess, still a drag and not very popular, but everyone knows he is sick and not helpless. When he comes to A.A. he knows quite a bit about it. While this does not lessen our responsibility, it may change the kind of help they need. Although they need less assurance that their problem is not a moral one, they need to learn that A.A. is not a clinic, but a fellowship and a way of life. They need sponsorship—sympathy with understanding. There is no less need today for carrying the message, and now it carries with it thirty-five years of success and more people to do the job.

But let's not get lazy, and expect other people to do our work; our service tasks get greater and not smaller as time goes on.

Our recovery program is the most successful of any program that has been tried to help alcoholics. We are bound to be a target for criticism, but this is good. It keeps us from feeling smug and self-satisfied. But this does not take from us the responsibility to take our own inventory and look carefully as

far as we can see. Many professionals feel that they can do better in getting alcoholics started in sobriety, then turning them over to A.A. for maintaining this sobriety. But we must not depend on others to do this, keep the hand of A.A. there. No one can offer hope with as much conviction as an A.A. member or break through the alcoholic's rationale so that he will be willing to admit that his life has become unmanageable.

Though we welcome all the help we can get, we should always accept our responsibilities, with central offices, P.I., groups in hospitals and prisons, etc. This has been true since the beginning of the Fellowship and nothing has happened to change this and nothing ever will.

The recent World Service Meeting fulfilled such a responsibility. We shared a joy and excitement beyond our area, state or nation. The conscientiousness that we are one, worldwide, was there and the knowledge that others are having the same problems that we had and are finding the same answers.

Many of the panels in the committees and discussions have impressed me deeply. The way in which this whole Conference has faced questions, squarely and openly, accepting other answers with an open mind. You have accomplished much and I am grateful.

—John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman
General Service Board of A.A.

KEYNOTE (from p. 8)

We have said that some members cut themselves out of the service picture of A.A. This is a rejection of something so vital to our very existence done without any knowledge of the vitality of the total program.

What is service? Yes, it's a 10-cent cup of coffee—it's getting up at 2:00 a.m. to call on a sick alcoholic—it's an area assembly or a General Service Conference—it's cooking a corned beef and cabbage dinner for a St. Patrick's Day celebration. It's the end of the broom.

Service Is Love in Action

It's learning and serving—and a living and giving—and a caring and sharing—and that's what it's all about.

In this A.A. way of life we have three great and lasting Legacies; Recovery, Unity, and Service. And the greatest of these is Service, for service encompasses all three—and service is love, the language of the heart, in action. *Service is the heart of A.A.*

—Eric B., Regional Trustee
N.W. Region

Conference Committee Reports

The following reports were presented to the Conference by Committee Chairmen and their acceptance by the Delegates constituted Advisory Actions of the Conference.

'DELEGATES ONLY' MEETING

The following resolutions were acted upon at the Area Delegates Only Meeting, Wednesday, April 22:

1. That the Delegates Only Meeting be held on Tuesday night of the Conference instead of Wednesday night.
2. That the General Service Office have the right to choose the hotel for the 1971 General Service Conference without conferring further with the delegates to the Conference.
3. That a separate, one-page agenda be printed for the convenience of the delegates.
4. Passed a resolution of thanks to Lois for standing by Bill all these years.
5. Reaffirmed the action of the Committee on Conference Policy to appoint a task force to take the Conference's inventory.
6. Unanimously elected Margaret C., Western Massachusetts, as the 1971 Area Delegates' chairman.

— Bob B., Okla., *Chairman
Delegates Only Meeting*

AGENDA/ADMISSIONS

The Conference Committee on Agenda/Admissions:

1. Recommended that all Conference agenda subjects received during the year, where time permits, be referred to the Agenda/Admissions Committee before presentation to the Policy and Board Committees for final approval.
2. Recommended that delegates should go back to their areas and determine if any obstacle exists which might create the illusion that an additional delegate is needed.
3. The following motion made and carried: "Let it be moved that this committee recommends to the assembled General Service Conference of 1970 that the moratorium

be continued until such time as the G.S.B. Long-Range Planning Committee, in conjunction with the Agenda/Admissions Committee, presents a set of guidelines to a future Conference for its approval." This is to be done by communication between the members of the two committees, either by mail or a meeting in the fall, if necessary.

4. It was also recommended: "In view of the fact that we are asking for basic guidelines from this committee and the Long-Range Planning Committee, the six proposals pertaining to the size of the Conference should be held in abeyance until we have an opportunity to consider any other ideas, and that each member of the Agenda/Admissions Committee be requested to accept the responsibility of forwarding some suggestions to the secretary of the committee."
5. Unanimously approved the following resolution: "Be it resolved that each member of this committee accept personal responsibility for the fulfillment of action proposed at these sessions."
6. Elected Terry P., Manitoba, as the chairman for the 1971 Agenda/Admissions Committee.

CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

The Committee of the Conference Report and Charter:

1. Reaffirms that the first names and last initials only be used in the main content of the *Final Conference Report* and *Conference Box 4-5-9* (Digest), but that names will appear in full in the last three and a half pages (roster section) of the *Final Report*.
2. Recommends that the roster section of the *Final Report* have dotted guidelines indicated near the pamphlet's spine, so that in the event the *Report* is given to anyone outside the Fellowship, the delegate involved should accept the responsibility of removing these pages.
3. Recommended that G.S.O. consider reducing the cost of the *Report* for bulk buying.
4. Recommended a wording change be made in Article 10, line 11 of the Conference Charter, substituting the words "General Service Trustees-at-Large" for "Regional General Service Trustees."
5. Elected Ralph F., Nebraska, as the chairman of the 1971 Conference Report and Charter Committee.

ADVISORY ACTIONS

FINANCE

The Conference Committee on Finance:

1. Recommended better utilization of the G.S.O. filmstrip should be made and suggested that it be distributed in slide form to make it more convenient to use.
2. Recommended that the area committees consider a symposium of services that would include an educational program for G.S.R.'s in the workings of their groups and their relation to G.S.O. The need to employ more articulate people, especially in the role of G.S.R., is stressed.
3. Recommended the extension of the Birthday Plan to include the birthdays of individual groups as well as of individual members.
4. Recommended that area and state committees supplement regular group contributions by sponsoring a Gratitude Month, with special emphasis on participation by all groups. Arrangements to be made by the committee for each group participating to receive individual credit.
5. Agreed to incorporate the idea of a Gratitude Month into the next money folder.
6. Recommended that these suggestions to increase group support of General Services be included in *Box 4-5-9* in future issues.
7. Elected Hal C., San Diego, California, as the chairman for the Conference Finance Committee.

CONFERENCE POLICY

The Committee on Conference Policy:

1. Recommended that the procedure for selecting Conference committee members continue to be from the hat; that no area be represented on any standing committee for more than two consecutive years; that when any state or province has more than one area that no standing committee will have more than one member from each state or province.
2. Recommended that in keeping with our Traditions, no cameras be allowed at any G.S.O. Conference session.

(It was agreed to send questions about using cameras and tape recorders at Conference sessions to the delegates in advance of the Conference meeting.)
3. Recommended that the area Hi-Lites be given in the second year of a delegate's term in order that the delegate might be more familiar with the subject matter and

new delegates be simply introduced to the Conference by name and area. (Not accepted by Conference.)

4. Recommended that it would be in the best interests of the Conference to have a special Task Force appointed to review the procedures and mechanics of the General Service Conference.

It was suggested that Recommendations one through three not be taken into consideration provided this Task Force is appointed at this time. (It was recommended and approved that it would be in the best interests of the Conference to have such a special Task Force, appointed by Dr. John Norris, to review procedures and mechanics of the General Service Conference as it is presently constituted.)

5. Elected Bill W., Alberta, Canada, as chairman of the 1971 Committee on Conference Policy.

LITERATURE

The Conference Committee on Literature:

1. Recommended that the Grapevine reprints of Bill's articles, "Problems Other than Alcohol" and "Why Alcoholics Anonymous is Anonymous" be considered by A.A.W.S. for pricing and inclusion in the G.S.O. order blank.
2. Recommended that the suggestion of the 1969 Conference Literature Committee that a cartoon-style booklet illustrative of the history of A.A. and service activities of G.S.O. be pursued, but that the history be confined to the early years at G.S.O. so that the project will have cohesion.
3. Recommended that "A Clergyman Looks at A.A." be considered for revision if the response from a selected number of A.A. and non-A.A. clergymen to whom it will be mailed for comment warrants.
4. Recommended that delegates continue to explore the possibility of placing the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous," and the other Conference-approved books in local libraries wherever this has not already been done.
5. Recommended that each group choose a member to be responsible for literature display at each meeting, as was recommended by the 1969 Conference.
6. Recommended that occasionally group discussions center around the Conference-approved pamphlet, such as "sponsorship," "Is A.A. for You?" "This is A.A." or any of the others that would be suitable for such discussion.
7. Elected Herman F., Wyoming, as the chairman for the 1971 Conference Literature Committee.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

The Conference Committee on Public Information:

1. Recommended that a brief statement be prepared — no longer than the A.A. Preamble — explaining why A.A. retains the Tradition of anonymity at the media and film level.
2. Approved the idea of combining all present material pertaining to radio-TV appearances by A.A. members with a new memo, covering discussion topics for such shows.
3. Recommended that a small folder (similar to the "Management" folder) be considered for use in schools.
4. Elected James C., Western New York, as the chairman of the 1971 Conference Committee on Public Information.

INSTITUTIONS

The Conference Committee on Institutions:

1. Recommended that the possibility of separating the hospital and prison services into subcommittees of the present Institutions Conference Committee be discussed with the membership and presented again on the agenda of the 1971 Institutions Committee.
2. Recommended that a group institutions representative be chosen at the discretion of the group, when practical.
3. Recommended that an effort be made to contact doctors and other personnel by personal visit or phone call to ask their help in informing other doctors about the Fellowship of A.A.
4. Agreed to help in the formation of an Institutional Committee in an area where none exists, that A.A. members from other areas who are experienced in institutional committee work be consulted or asked to speak at an area assembly meeting on the subject.
5. Recommended that the wording of the 1969 Institutions Committee recommendation concerning the definition of A.A.'s position on membership in institutional groups be changed to read as follows: "Open meetings are traditionally open to all interested in A.A., but should be devoted exclusively to the alcoholic problem. Closed meetings should traditionally be restricted to alcoholics."
6. Elected Cecil H., South Carolina, as the chairman of the 1971 Conference Committee on Institutions.

TRUSTEES

The Conference Committee on Trustees:

1. Recommended that a regional or general service trustee-at-large candidate may be elected from each Conference area or that two or more of the Conference areas within a state or province may jointly propose a single candidate.
2. Agreed that the proposal to change the regional trustee candidates' resumes to eliminate any educational background and outside A.A. activities was not in the best interest of A.A. and recommended that we continue to ask for educational background and outside A.A. activities in resumes.
3. Reviewed the recommendation that the proposal, i.e., any delegate shall not be eligible as trustee candidate for a full year after ending the term as area delegate, and found this recommendation not consistent with the best interest of A.A. as it would eliminate many qualified candidates and therefore was not accepted.
4. Recommended that a regional trustee shall not be a candidate for a general service trustee-at-large.
5. Recommended that the proposal re a 75-mile (from New York City) limitation on trustee-at-large candidates be rescinded on the basis that it is discriminatory; bylaws to be amended accordingly.
6. Recommended Arthur Miles as a non-A.A. trustee of the General Service Board.
7. Accepted the slate of trustees and officers of the General Service Board read by the chairman. (Listing may be found on p.35, in the report of the Trustees' Nominating Committee.)
8. Elected Bob R., Georgia, as the chairman for the 1971 Conference Committee on Trustees.

GRAPEVINE

The Conference Grapevine Committee:

1. Discussed plans and suggestions for the Grapevine, covering editorial activities, circulation comparisons, promotion, material and contributions, financial positions and GV representatives.
2. Reviewed recommendations and actions of past Grapevine committees and reaffirmed plans to act as Grapevine representatives in their areas, to request past Grapevines for use in institutions and to carry Grapevine message as a vital tool when making reports to areas.
3. Elected Helen S., New Hampshire, as the chairman of the 1971 Conference Grapevine Committee.

ADVISORY ACTIONS

ACTIONS OF WORLD SERVICE MEETING ACCEPTED

A motion was made, seconded and unanimously approved that the 20th General Service Conference accept the following advisory actions of the first World Service Meeting:

1. That the first World Service Meeting was worthwhile, and delegates approved the idea of holding future meetings.
2. Approved having the next meeting in three years, although some were in favor of two or four years.
3. That the expenses of the next meeting should be shared on a more equitable basis, if possible.
4. New York was the unanimous choice for the site of the next World Service Meeting, although it was agreed that future meetings should be held in other areas of the world when it becomes feasible.
5. The principle of rotation regarding the election of delegates to future meetings was accepted. However, it was noted that each country will determine the method of election or appointment of its own delegates. It was suggested that new delegates might be elected on a staggered rotation basis.
6. Delegates agreed to the formation of four committees to conduct the business of the World Service Meeting until the next gathering. These were: Policy, Finance, Agenda/Admissions and Literature/Publishing. Delegates agreed that members of these committees would be chosen by lot.

• • •

Delegates accepted the Area Support Proposal, with the recommendation that G.S.O. bill the 90 Conference areas for \$150, with a March 1 deadline for sending it to G.S.O.

• • •

The Conference accepted the recommendation resulting from floor discussion that the Fellowship go on record as opposing the use of the title, "A.A. Counselor."

• • •

Following three-minute presentations and voting under Third Legacy procedures, the name of Jim H. was presented to the General Service Board for election as the first general service trustee-at-large from the United States. His biography can be found on p. 50.

Bill's Statement On His Finances

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie:

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership.

Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

*Ever yours,
Bill
(Signed in full)*

P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

TRIP TO BEDFORD HILLS

One of the highlights of the Conference experience is the delegates' visit with Bill and Lois in their lovely home in Bedford Hills, New York, a journey by bus of some two hours from the center of Manhattan.

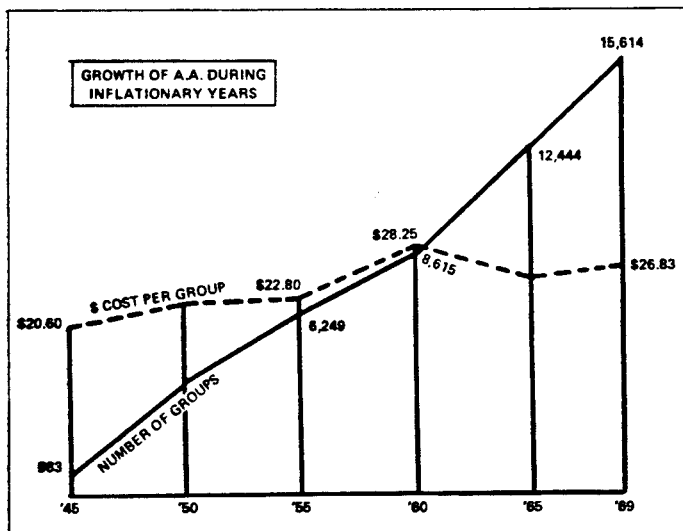
This visit, scheduled every other year, climaxes the spiritually moving closing session of the Conference on Saturday morning and delegates always feel it is a wonderful finale to a full and satisfying week of A.A. activity. This year at "Stepping Stones" the dogwoods were approaching full bloom, the tulips, forsythia and spring flowers were still "in season" and much admired. Delegates and their wives enjoyed refreshments with Lois, a leisurely walk around the lawns and a tour of the house and Bill's studio "up the hill" before returning to New York.

Growth & Money at G.S.O.

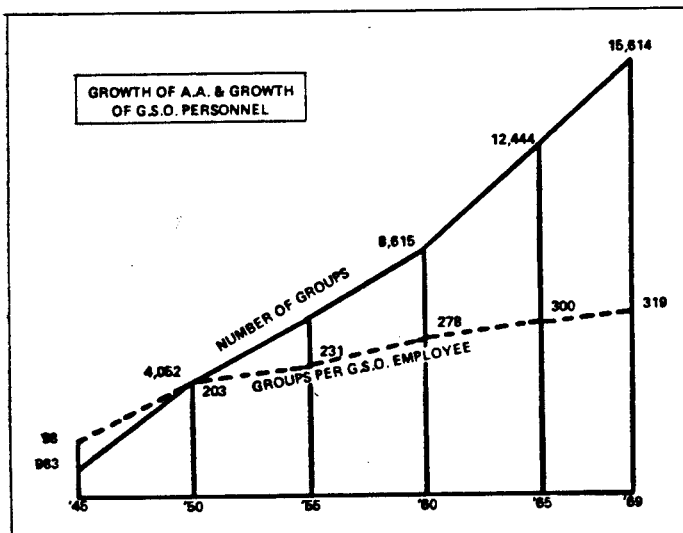
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel – in 1945 there was one employee for each 98 groups. Today, one employee serves each 319 groups.

During the past twenty four years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$20,000 to \$479,100 for services charged to the group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 104%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per group actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$13.15.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1945	983	10	98	\$20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1969	15,614	49	319	26.83	204



1. (Above) There are more than 15 times as many groups today as in 1945. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 319 groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 98 in 1945.



2. (Above) During the years 1945 through 1969, the cost of living increased 104 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per group to \$26.83 in 1969 compared with \$20.60 in 1945, an increase of only 30 percent.

1970 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1970 Operations of G.S.O. activities – Exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine – is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$510,000*
Less: Cost of Products	209,100
Gross Profit from Sales	300,900

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	88,000
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*Based upon the sale of:

- 51,800 Books – “Alcoholics Anonymous”
- 17,000 Books – “12 Steps & 12 Traditions” (Reg.)
- 6,200 Books – “12 Steps & 12 Traditions” (Pocket)
- 6,900 Books – “A.A. Comes of Age”
- 13,000 Books – “The A.A. Way of Life”
- Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

OFFICE EXPENSES – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$417,100
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	(62,000)
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**Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$ 36,300

GENERAL FUND—TRUSTEES' EXPENSES

INCOME

\$ –0–

TOTAL EXPENSES

125,000***

Excess of Income (Expense)	(125,000)
----------------------------	-----------

***Board Meetings, P.J.C. Expense, Special Projects.
Architects fee and construction costs (re-locating office).

The Publishing activity will contribute \$88,000 to the budgeted deficits.

1970 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales.....	\$246,000
Estimated Expense.....	232,400

Net income from operations.....	13,600
Interest from Savings accounts.....	8,700

Net income.....	22,300
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1969 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alabama	75	39	52.0%	9	23.1%	\$ 2,569.04	1,229	\$ 2.09
Alaska	38	18	47.4	6	30.0	1,061.40	312	3.40
Arizona	129	70	54.2	20	28.6	4,612.41	1,661	2.78
Arkansas	78	50	64.1	12	24.0	2,880.69	918	3.14
California	1,327	781	58.9	264	33.8	51,139.72	30,132	1.70
Colorado	110	73	66.3	21	28.8	4,613.52	1,770	2.61
Connecticut	198	127	64.6	31	24.4	8,500.08	3,183	2.67
Delaware	33	27	81.9	9	33.3	1,384.00	427	3.25
Dist. of Columbia	52	37	71.1	19	51.4	4,326.17	1,257	3.44
Florida	283	199	70.3	71	35.7	17,502.24	5,020	3.49
Georgia	157	100	64.0	30	30.0	4,403.42	2,232	1.97
Hawaii	32	17	53.2	4	23.6	709.27	516	1.37
Idaho	35	24	68.6	4	16.7	798.58	355	2.25
Illinois	636	512	80.6	46	9.0	11,773.41	12,629	.93
Indiana	189	125	66.1	21	16.9	8,159.04	2,647	3.08
Iowa	116	66	56.9	13	19.7	5,326.75	2,302	2.31
Kansas	109	71	65.2	15	21.2	3,711.39	2,184	1.70
Kentucky	110	74	67.3	6	8.1	6,896.38	1,336	5.16
Louisiana	88	63	71.6	17	27.0	3,272.38	1,590	2.06
Maine	57	37	65.0	6	16.2	1,504.50	632	2.38
Maryland	153	108	70.6	26	24.1	5,987.05	2,193	2.73
Massachusetts	295	158	53.5	43	27.2	9,818.90	5,608	1.75
Michigan	375	230	61.3	57	24.8	16,772.91	6,103	2.75
Minnesota	242	168	69.4	16	9.6	8,624.90	6,085	1.42
Mississippi	48	29	60.5	9	31.1	1,521.50	736	2.07
Missouri	167	105	63.0	26	24.8	5,750.77	2,335	2.46
Montana	62	38	61.3	6	15.8	1,131.75	618	1.83
Nebraska	76	54	71.0	9	16.7	2,922.40	829	3.53
Nevada	51	31	60.9	12	38.7	2,072.10	776	2.67
New Hampshire	38	23	60.5	7	30.4	1,540.00	601	2.56
New Jersey	269	199	74.0	52	26.1	13,493.10	4,283	3.15
New Mexico	64	29	45.3	6	21.0	1,485.88	863	1.72
New York	584	403	69.0	133	33.0	31,885.17	10,676	2.99
North Carolina	173	126	72.8	23	18.4	6,802.27	2,519	2.70
North Dakota	50	22	44.0	3	13.7	890.50	492	1.81
Ohio	494	262	53.0	66	25.2	15,845.70	9,088	1.74
Oklahoma	114	84	73.7	37	44.1	4,768.05	1,680	2.84
Oregon	118	73	61.9	15	20.6	2,874.68	1,219	2.36
Pennsylvania	331	227	68.6	59	26.0	16,526.81	4,888	3.38
Rhode Island	34	26	76.5	11	42.3	2,138.67	399	5.36
South Carolina	84	44	52.4	10	22.7	2,547.21	1,294	1.97
South Dakota	50	26	52.0	4	15.4	1,066.00	893	1.19
Tennessee	88	58	65.8	11	19.0	2,585.75	1,507	1.72
Texas	414	224	54.1	67	29.9	15,020.63	8,200	1.83
Utah	57	29	50.9	11	37.9	980.84	801	1.22
Vermont	31	25	80.6	4	16.0	1,813.50	381	4.76
Virginia	159	109	68.6	40	36.8	7,455.41	2,534	2.94
Washington	205	128	62.5	34	26.7	8,639.46	2,393	3.61</

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1969

	<u>1969</u>	<u>1968</u>
INCOME		
Net Sales, after Book Discounts waived of \$36,435 in 1969 and \$32,825 in 1968	\$472,727	\$431,844
Less: Cost of Printing	133,944	120,656
Royalties	51,934	47,606
Gross Profit from Literature	286,849	263,582
Contributions – A.A. Groups and Members	397,146	366,215
Interest	–	143
Total Income	<u>\$683,995</u>	<u>\$629,940</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	\$349,635	\$326,294
Rent	34,324	35,097
Architects' Fees	15,000	–
Exchange Bulletin	15,587	14,001
World Directory	21,820	20,061
Other Service Office Printing	14,149	11,164
Shipping and Mailing	52,987	46,543
Other Office Expenses	50,293	48,492
Insurance and Taxes	28,378	26,478
Professional Services, Gifts	10,792	10,600
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	11,850	11,855
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	7,717	7,341
P.J.C., Travel	9,361	16,687
General Service Conference	35,310	36,571
1969 World Meeting	13,736	–
Foreign Literature Aid	2,989	3,623
Film, Film Strip, Display Boards	1,326	4,034
Total Expense	<u>\$675,254</u>	<u>\$618,841</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>8,741</u>	<u>11,099</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

World Service Office – Group Fund	\$ (21,733)	\$ (37,528)
Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	91,023	91,321
General Fund – General Service Board	(60,549)	(42,694)

CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1969

	<u>Convention</u>	<u>Pension</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Balance, January 1, 1969	\$ 14,031	\$ 25,912	\$300,099
Book Discounts		36,435	
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500	
Investment Income	643	741	15,600
Transfers (to) from Other Funds			(15,600)
Less: Current Funding Costs		(31,154)	
Additional Funding of Past Service Cost		(20,000)	
Actuary Fee		(1,879)	
Balance, December 31, 1969	<u>\$ 14,674</u>	<u>\$ 13,555</u>	<u>\$300,099</u>

() Denotes Red Figures

In the attached financial statements amounts under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in saving accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance Committee.

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the Retirement Plan for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

(continued on p. 46)

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1969

	<u>1969</u>	<u>1968</u>
INCOME – SUBSCRIPTIONS AND SALES	\$224,989	\$208,801
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS		
Salaries	31,954	32,709
Printing	48,282	45,635
Mailing	26,982	24,293
Other Printing Costs	1,537	2,040
Calendar Costs	7,170	5,926
Rent	5,396	5,224
Telephone	1,029	1,075
Office Supplies and Expense	1,503	1,404
Other Editorial Expense	3,516	3,475
Office Cleaning	600	500
Total	<u>\$127,969</u>	<u>\$122,281</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS EXPENSE		
Salaries	\$ 37,979	36,770
Stationery and Supplies	2,471	2,576
Rent	5,396	5,224
Telephone	827	827
Office Expense	3,685	2,829
Selling	5,886	5,625
Postage	4,350	3,980
Office Cleaning	600	500
Bad Debts	418	293
Conference and Convention	20	334
Total	<u>\$ 61,632</u>	<u>\$ 58,958</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	\$ 3,107	\$ 2,803
Legal and Accounting	3,700	3,100
Taxes	4,840	4,804
Meetings	499	385
New Equipment	546	695
Contribution to Retirement Fund	3,500	3,500
Total	<u>\$ 16,192</u>	<u>\$ 15,287</u>
TOTAL COST AND EXPENSE	<u>\$205,793</u>	<u>\$196,526</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	\$ 19,196	\$ 12,275
Add: Interest Received on Savings Accounts	<u>5,877</u>	<u>5,064</u>
NET INCOME FOR PERIOD (Exhibit C)	<u>\$ 25,073</u>	<u>\$ 17,339</u>

(continued from p. 45)

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY FUND was established in 1967 by subscriptions from A.A. members in Miami, Florida, and by a transfer from the GENERAL FUND for the purpose of making up a deficit, if any, incurred in connection with the Convention to be held in Miami in 1970. To the extent not so used it is to be refunded to the original subscribers.

The CONVENTION OPERATING FUND was established in 1969 to record the fiscal operations of the 1970 International Convention. Any resulting surplus will be transferred to the GENERAL FUND.

(continued on p. 47)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1969

	December 31, 1969		December 31, 1968	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash	\$168,172	\$ 28,525	\$154,140	\$ 30,926
Savings Accounts and Certificates		120,951		115,074
Marketable Securities		24,938		
Accounts Receivable	15,418	2,663	10,642	3,997
Due from Grapevine Convention Operating and Reserve Funds	37,878		22,300	
Inventories	106,700	977	112,500	2,439
Prepaid Expenses	25,240	4,551	5,028	3,426
Total Assets	<u>\$353,408</u>	<u>\$182,605</u>	<u>\$304,610</u>	<u>\$155,862</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	27,659	19,487	14,168	4,668
Due Pension Fund	2,848		2,382	
Due General Fund				8,000
Prepaid Subscriptions, Unearned Income		90,539		83,688
Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments		7,000		7,000
Reserve for EDP Installation	18,500		20,000	
Total Liabilities	<u>\$ 49,007</u>	<u>\$117,026</u>	<u>\$ 36,550</u>	<u>\$103,356</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	268,060	52,506	234,661	43,167
Net Income for Year (Exhibits A and B)	8,741	25,073	11,099	17,339
Dividend (paid) or received	12,000	(12,000)	8,000	(8,000)
Transfers from Reserve Fund	15,600		14,300	
Total Net Worth	<u>\$304,401</u>	<u>\$ 65,579</u>	<u>\$268,060</u>	<u>\$ 52,506</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
World Service Office - Group Fund (Note B)	\$ 11,123		\$ 11,156	
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	184,622		178,599	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Notes A and B)	108,656		78,305	
Total Operating Funds - as above	<u>\$304,401</u>		<u>\$268,060</u>	
Reserve Fund	300,099		300,099	
Deferred Pension Fund	13,555		25,912	
Convention Guaranty Fund	14,674		14,031	
Total Net Worth	<u>\$632,729</u>		<u>\$608,102</u>	
RESERVE, DEFERRED PENSION AND CONVENTION FUNDS				
	Reserve	Pension	Convention Guaranty	Operating
Cash	\$ 949	\$	\$	\$ 35,527
Savings accounts and certificates	6,341	18,495	14,674	
Due from A.A.W.S. and General Fund		2,848		
U.S. Treasury obligations	224,863			
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	79,320			
Accrued Interest	4,226			
Preliminary operating expenses				16,022
Less: Due General Fund	(15,600)			(10,278)
A.A. Retirement Trust		(7,788)		
Advance Receipts				(41,271)
BALANCE, DECEMBER 31	<u>\$300,099</u>	<u>\$ 13,555</u>	<u>\$ 14,674</u>	<u>-</u>

() Denotes Red Figures

(continued from p. 46)

In the attached statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc., are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, and of the other Funds by their names.

NOTE A - After transfers of \$85,000 in 1969, and \$65,000 in 1968 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B - Transfers of \$21,700 in 1969 and \$37,500 in 1968 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in group contributions in those years.

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

1970 CONFERENCE MEMBERS*

Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

Bill Wilson --- Co-founder

NONALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

John L. Norris, M.D. (Chairman)
Box 251
New London, N.H. 03257

Travis E. Dancey, M.D.
4015 Wilson Avenue
Montreal 28, Quebec, Canada

Vincent Dole, M.D.
Rockefeller University
67th St. & York Ave.
New York, New York 10021

Austin H. MacCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30th Street
New York, New York 10016

Arthur Miles (Treasurer)
212 Poplar Street
Floral Park, N. Y. 11001

Hon. John Murtagh
Justice of the Supreme Court of
the State of N. Y.
100 Centre Street
New York, New York 10013

Bernard B. Smith (1st Vice Chairman)
460 Park Avenue
New York, New York 10022

ALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

Arthur "Andy" Anderson (Secretary)
3565 Sunset Lane
Port Huron, Michigan 48660

Eric H. Bergman
8435 47 Avenue South
Seattle, Washington 98118

William Coogan
40 Court Street
Boston, Mass. 02108

Rollie G. Davidson (2nd Vice Chairman)
Habitat 67, Apt. 1022
Cite du Havre
Montreal 2, Que., Canada

Don Farrell
108 So. 53rd Street
Omaha, Nebraska 68132

Stephen Owen, Sr.
229 Hollywood Crossing
Lawrence, L.I., N.Y. 11519

Robert G. Pearson
1 Jones Park
Riverside, Conn. 06878

Bayard Pope, Jr.
B.B.D. & O.
383 Madison Avenue
New York, New York

Katharine Prince
2305 Chidester Road
Camden, Arkansas 71701

John Rae
Heatherview Manor, Apt. 7
Swift Current, Sask., Canada

Maurice E. Reilly, Jr.
7726 Jeannette Street
New Orleans, Louisiana 70118

Ruth M. Weir
145 East 15 Street
New York, New York 10003

James E. Hiers
608 Cleermont Drive, S.E.
Huntsville, Alabama 35801

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Ruth Weir (Chairman & President)
Jack Morley (Editor)
Paula Carpenter (Vice President, Secretary)
David A. Barron (Acting Treasurer)
Austin MacCormick
Milton Maxwell, Ph. D.
Robert Pearson
Ralph Ahringer
George N. Gordon

A.A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

Robert E. Hitchins (Chairman)
Bayard Pope, Jr. (1st Vice Chairman)
Waneta New (2nd Vice Chairman)
Stephen Owen, Sr. (Treasurer)
Walter Murphy
Robert Pearson
Robert Macpherson
Hazel Rice (Secretary)

GRAPEVINE STAFF

Paula Carpenter
Jack Morley

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

Robert E. Hitchins
Cora Louise Belford
Beth Kuhlmann
Ann Macfarlane
Midge McFadden
Waneta New
Eleanor Newman
Hazel Rice
Mary Ellen Uribe

Al Cryan, Manager, Shipping
Rose Failla, Manager, Records
Kleina Jones, Manager, Special Services
Madeline Whitlock, Supervisor, Clerical/Steno

Nell Wing, Production Editor, Box 4-5-9
Dennis Manders, Controller
Charles Columbia, Supervisor, Accounting
Wilbur A. Smith (Ind. C.P.A.)
William Smith, C.P.A.

Two Observers from: Public Information Committee
Two Observers from: Literature Committee
Two Observers from: Grapevine Editorial Board

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Nonalcoholic Trustees

JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D. . . . is chairman of the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January 1951. "Dr. Jack" retired last year as associate medical director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, N.Y. He is chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and a former president of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record suggests, Dr. Jack has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

TRAVIS E. DANCEY, M.D. . . . elected to the Board in January 1965. He is chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital and senior psychiatrist of Montreal General Hospital. A good friend of the Fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. group in Quebec, Dr. Dancey is the first nonalcoholic trustee to serve from Canada. He serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

VINCENT P. DOLE, M.D. . . . elected to the General Service Board in April 1965. He is a professor and physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in the treatment of narcotic addiction and is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the Policy Committee of the General Service Board.

AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK . . . elected to the General Service Board in April 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October 1949 to April 1951. He left in 1951 to become professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a director of the A.A. Grapevine,

a member of its corporate and editorial boards, and also serves on the Trustees' Nominating Committee and is chairman of its Literature Committee.

ARTHUR J. MILES . . . is new treasurer . . . was elected to the Board in April 1970. He is a senior vice president of the Dime Savings Bank of Brooklyn and on the Board of Trustees of the American Institute of Banking and the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He resides in Floral Park, L.I. with his wife and two children.

THE HON. JOHN M. MURTAGH . . . elected to the Board in April 1963. He is a justice of the Supreme Court of the State of New York. Previously he had been administrative judge of the Criminal Court of New York, chief justice of the Court of Special Sessions, chief city magistrate, and commissioner of investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. Long a good friend of A.A., the judge brings to the Board a sure understanding of the alcoholism illness.

BERNARD B. SMITH . . . is 1st vice chairman of the Board - was elected to the Board in June 1944 and has been very active, serving as chairman of the Board and General Service Conference from January 1951 to April 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire, from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth II, on her visit to the United States.

A.A. Trustees

ARTHUR "ANDY" ANDERSON . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the East Central Region. He had his last drink in 1949. Andy was a delegate to the General Service Conference and helped to initiate a statewide General Service Committee and P.I. Committee. He was instrumental in forming the Michigan State Police and is with Chrysler Corporation, in charge of government parts' inspection. Andy serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

ERIC H. BERGMAN . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the Pacific Region. He had his last drink in 1951. He has served as G.S.R., vice chairman and chairman of the Seattle Intergroup and delegate to the General Service Conference. He is purchasing manager for Sicks' Rainier Brewing Company. Eric serves on the Trustees' Finance, Nominating and Policy Committees.

BILL COOGAN - Elected to the Board April 1969, as trustee from the Northeast Region. Since his last drink 13 years ago, Bill has served in many capacities from group treasurer to area delegate (1965-1966). He is a lawyer practicing in the metropolitan area of Boston, Massachusetts,

where he lives. He is a member of the Harvard Alumni Association, the Boston College Alumni Association, the American Bar Association and the Massachusetts Trial Lawyers Association. He serves on the Trustees' Literature and Policy Committees.

ROLLIE G. DAVIDSON . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from Eastern Canada. He had his last drink in 1950. He has served as general secretary of the Intergroup at Montreal; chairman, Quebec General Service Committee; worked with the French translation of A.A. literature, and been a delegate to the General Service Conference. He is vice president and insurance engineer of Hagar and Pettigrew. Rollie serves on the Policy and Nominating Committees.

DONALD F. FARRELL . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April 1968 as trustee from the West Central Region. He had his last drink in 1943. Besides helping to start A.A. in Des Moines, he was one of the original members in Omaha. A former delegate, he is active in institutions work and court programs for alcoholics. Don owns and operates a photographic business. He serves on the Trustees' Literature and Policy Committees.

A.A. TRUSTEES (from page 49)

STEPHEN OWEN, SR. — Elected to the Board April 1969, started serving the end of July. Steve had his last drink November, 1960. He has served as secretary, treasurer, program chairman, and G.S.R. for his group in Long Beach, Long Island; has had intergroup experience, serving as treasurer in 1962 and 1963. He has now retired as president of the Beacon Manufacturing Company, a textile firm. Steve serves on the Trustees, Finance and Literature Committees.

ROBERT PEARSON . . . was elected to the General Service Board in July 1968. He had his last drink in 1961. He is a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board, as well as of A.A.W.S., Inc. He was chairman of the Public Information Committee of the New York Intergroup and is a former president of the Fairfield County (Conn.) Council on Alcoholism. He is a member of the Grapevine Board of Directors and serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

BAYARD POPE, JR. . . . was elected to the General Service Board as a service trustee in January 1968. He had his last drink in 1959. He is presently chairman of the Public Information Committee. He was a member of the Steering Committee and chairman of the Public Information Committee of the Intergroup Association of New York and now is on the Executive Committee of the Community Council on Alcoholism. He is vice president and a director of Batten, Barton, Durstine and Osborn. Bayard also serves on the Trustees' Policy and P.I. Committees and is a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.

KATHARINE PRINCE . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the Southwest Region. She had her last drink in 1949 and is a member of the Camden, Arkansas Group. She has been a G.S.R. in Oklahoma and Arkansas, an area committee member, and helped form the Tulsoma (Oklahoma) Group. She was assistant secretary-treasurer of the Southwestern Art Association. Katharine serves on the Trustees' Policy and Nominating Committees.

JOHN RAE — Elected to the Board April 1969, as trustee from the Western Canada Region. John has been sober over 14 years, and has been active in group and area affairs, serving as delegate to the General Service Conference (1960-61). He is manager of the Medical Clinic, Swift Current, Saskatchewan, Canada and active in many civic associations in his region. He serves on the Trustees, Literature and Policy Committee.

MAURICE E. REILLY, JR. . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the Southwest Region. He had his last drink in 1956. He has served as G.S.R., committee member, state chairman and delegate for Louisiana. He also served as vice chairman of the Central Office Board. He is an architect in private practice and is a member of several professional organizations. Maurice serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

RUTH M. WEIR . . . was elected to the General Service Board as a service trustee in April 1967. She had her last drink in 1954. She has been active with the New York Intergroup Association and is chairman and president of the Grapevine Board. She is a financial administrator for the J. Walter Thompson Company. Ruth also serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

JAMES E. HIERS. . . . was elected to the General Service Board as trustee-at-large from the United States in April, 1970. He had his last drink in 1951 and was a Panel 7 delegate to the General Service Conference. Active in numerous charitable and civic associations, Jim is the administrative management officer for NASA at Huntsville, Alabama, where he lives with his wife and three daughters.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEES

APRIL 1970

FINANCE & BUDGETARY

Arthur J. Miles, Chairman
Eric Bergman
Robert E. Hitchins
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Maurice Reilly, Jr.
Ruth Weir
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)
William Smith, C.P.A.
Dennis Manders, Secretary

Investment Advisory Committee

Arthur J. Miles, Chairman
Robert E. Hitchins
William G. Wilson
Chester Rude, Adviser
Dennis Manders, Secretary

Retirement Committee

Arthur J. Miles, Chairman
John L. Norris, M.D.
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)
William Smith, C.P.A.
Robert E. Hitchins, Secretary

LITERATURE

Austin MacCormick, Chairman
Stephen C. Owen, Sr., Co-chairman
Joel Bennett
William Coogan
Donald Farrell
Robert E. Hitchins
Barry Leach
Jack Morley
John Rae
Mary Elizabeth Sullivan
Janet Graves, Consultant
Ann Macfarlane, Secretary

POLICY

Maurice E. Reilly, Jr., Chairman
Arthur Anderson
Eric Bergman
William Coogan
Travis Dancey, M.D.
Rollie Davidson
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Donald Farrell
Robert E. Hitchins
Stephen C. Owen, Sr.
Robert Pearson
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Katharine Prince
John Rae
Hazel Rice
Ruth Weir
Waneta New, Secretary

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Bayard Pope, Jr., Chairman
Paula Carpenter
Jim Cassidy
Jerry Danzig
Janet Graves
John Henderson
Robert E. Hitchins
Rex Moody
Walter Murphy
Tom Rosenberg
Cora Louise Belford, Secretary

NOMINATING

Robert Pearson, Chairman
Eric Bergman, Co-chairman
Arthur Anderson
Travis Dancey, M.D.
Rollie Davidson
Robert E. Hitchins
Austin MacCormick
Walter Murphy
Katharine Prince
Beth Kuhlmann, Secretary

Trustees' Meetings

The Board of Trustees will meet during the coming year on the following dates: July 6, October 26, 1970; January 25 and April 24, 1971.

1970 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA	(19) Ted Cooper, P.O. Box 4363, Birmingham, Alabama 35206
ALASKA	(20) Pat Mauer, Box 1141, Kodiak, Alaska 99615
ARIZONA	(20) Betty Holmes, 4123 W. Virginia Avenue, Phoenix, Arizona 85009
ARKANSAS	(19) Neal Lancaster, P.O. Box 52, Siloam Springs, Arkansas 72761
CALIFORNIA	(19) Southern - Art F. Kolkman, Jr., 1432 Westmoreland Avenue, Los Angeles, Ca. 90006 (19) Northern Coastal - Ed Brown, 1929 Hershner Drive, San Jose, California 95124 (20) Northern Interior - Ralph Wag, 2459 San Jose Way, Sacramento, California 95817 (20) San Diego - Hal Cornelius, 222 E. Quintard, Chula Vista, Ca. 92011 (20) Southern Coastal - Ellery Stowell, 4801 Surrey Drive, Corona Del Mar, Ca. 92625
COLORADO	(19) Evelyn Bottom, 885 So. Ogden St., Denver, Colorado 80209
CONNECTICUT	(19) Charles Mitchell, 135 Alston Avenue, New Haven, Connecticut 06515
DELAWARE	(20) Lambert Seemans, P.O. Box 75, Odessa, Delaware 19730
D.C.	(19) Alex Blair, 1900 South Eads Street, Arlington, Virginia 22202
FLORIDA	(19) Northern - Earl K. Martin, P.O. Box 996, Merritt Island, Florida 32952 (19) Southern - Fred Stevenson, 4411 N. Federal Highway, Pompano, Florida 33064
GEORGIA	(20) Bob Ross, P.O. Box 10497, Atlanta, Georgia 30310
HAWAII	(19) Frances Roberts, 1019 Lunaai Place, Kailua, Hawaii 96734
IDAHO	(20) Edith Stoner, 402 - 2nd Street, Idaho Falls, Idaho 83401
ILLINOIS	(19) Chicago - Bill Williams, 4713 Langley Avenue, Chicago, Illinois 60615 (20) Northern - Roland Carlson, 409 Robert Avenue, Rockford, Illinois 61107

What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 20th Conference is made up of Panel 19 -- the old delegates -- and Panel 20 -- the new delegates.

STATE	PANEL
INDIANA	(19) Southern - Dick Lewis, 69 Town & Country Drive, Decatur, Illinois 62526 (19) Northern - Joe Hochderffer, 1530 Crescent Avenue, Fort Wayne, Ind. 46805 (20) Southern - Sam Faucett, Box 772, Evansville, Indiana 47701
IOWA	(19) R.E. "Bob" Anderson, Linn Grove, Iowa, 51033
KANSAS	(20) George Bohannon, 3007 California, Topeka, Kansas 66605
KENTUCKY	(20) Winston "Bud" Williams, 2231 Peaslee Road, Shively, Kentucky 40216
LOUISIANA	(19) Mabel Plyler, P.O. Box 233, Zachary, Louisiana 70791
MAINE	(20) Willard Ford, Box 2, Tenants Harbor, Maine
MARYLAND	(20) John O'Keefe, 712 Jackson Street, Salisbury, Maryland 21801
MASSACHUSETTS	(19) Eastern - Junior Anderson, 31 La Salle Road, Needham Heights, Ma. 02194 (20) Western - Margaret Carlson, 13 Ruth Drive, Wilbraham, Ma. 01095
MICHIGAN	(19) Central - Charles Darien, 4406 Crissman, Flint, Michigan 48505 (19) Southeast - Joseph Calcaterra, 12235 Ewald Court, Sterling Heights, Mi. 48087 (20) Western - Floyd D'Arcy, R #2, Box 141, Big Rapids, Michigan 49307
MINNESOTA	(20) Northern - Clarence Berg, Box 208, Fergus Falls, Minnesota 56537 (19) * Southern - George Zuelke, 411 S. Elm, Northfield, Minn.
MISSISSIPPI	(20) R.T. Douglas, Box 4773, Jackson, Mississippi

(continued)

Delegates (cont'd)

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
MISSOURI	(19) Eastern – Zora Hynes, 2430 Castle Drive, St. Louis, Missouri 63136	OKLAHOMA	(19) Bob Broach, 3913 East 40th, Tulsa, Oklahoma 74135
	(19) Western – Paul Simons, 2928 Mason, Independence, Missouri 64052	OREGON	(20) Betty Vaughan, 17605 S.E. Roethe Place, Milwaukie, Oregon 97222
MONTANA	(20) Ray C. Redfern, 2532 S. Montana, Butte, Montana 59701	PUERTO RICO	(20) Raul Pelegrina, Box 151, Catano, P.R. 00632
NEBRASKA	(20) Ralph Fox, 1601 Euclid, Lincoln, Nebraska 68502	PENNSYLVANIA	(19) Eastern – Monroe Brubaker, 224 So. 6th Street, Lebanon, Pa. 17042
NEVADA	(19) Bob Rodgers, 2440 E. 9th Street, Reno, Nevada 89502		(19) Western – Henry Carr, 421 Gettysburg Avenue, Pittsburgh, Pa. 15206
NEW HAMPSHIRE	(20) Helen Stevens, P.O. Box 31, Greenfield, New Hampshire 03047	RHODE ISLAND	(20) Joseph Fitzpatrick, 776 Hartford Avenue, Johnston, Rhode Island
NEW JERSEY	(19) Northern – Edmund Koeck, 10 Rosewood Drive, Madison, New Jersey 07940	SOUTH CAROLINA	(20) Cecil Hamilton, P.O. Box 140, Walterboro, South Carolina 29488
	(20) Southern – John Mills, 208 White Horse Pike, Oaklyn Manor Apts., Oaklyn, N.J. 08107	SOUTH DAKOTA	(20) Chuck Luke, 1609 Burliegh, Yankton, South Dakota 57078
NEW MEXICO	(20) Jimmy Dodson, P.O. Box 52, Peralta, New Mexico 87042	TENNESSEE	(20) Walter Hood, 311 Hamilton Road, S.W., Knoxville, Tennessee 37920
NEW YORK	(19) *Central – Jack Brownyard, 2220 Main St. E., Rochester, N.Y. 14609	TEXAS	(19) Northeast – Kenneth Jordan, 211 Dorothy Drive, Richardson, Texas 75080
	(20) Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Robert D. Wilson, 1821 Ferguson Street, Schenectady, New York 12303		(20) Northwest – Tom O'Neal, 4722 Oregon Trail, Amarillo, Texas 79109
	(19) Southeastern – George Stumpp, 36 Irwin Street, Sayville, New York 11782		(19) Southeast – Ina Lee Copeland, 8150 Gulf Freeway #93, Houston, Texas 77017
	(20) Western – James Campbell, 243 E. Amherst Street, Buffalo, New York 14214	UTAH	(20) Southwest – Doris Carter, 11905 Arabian Trail, Austin, Texas 78759
NORTH CAROLINA	(19) Wade Johnson, 5105 Bennington Road, Greensboro, North Carolina 27410	VERMONT	(19) Aurelia (Shorty) Batchelor, 469 16th Street, Ogden, Utah 84404
NORTH DAKOTA	(20) Arnold Jaeger, 1716 – 4th Street, Bismarck, North Dakota 58501		(20) Roy Clark, Box 491, Bristol, Vermont 05443
OHIO	(19) Central & Southeast – Marie Lucas, 498 Loraine Drive, Pickerington, Ohio 43147	VIRGINIA	(19) Mac Blair, P.O. Box 1207, Staunton, Virginia 24401
	(19) Northeast – John Low, 702 S. Main Street, No. Canton, Ohio 44720	WASHINGTON	(19) Al A. Dube, 421 So. 35th Avenue, Yakima, Washington 98902
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- (20) Bill Wheeler, 10370 - 58th Avenue,
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- (20) Terry Penton, 132 - 28th Street,
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**NEW BRUNSWICK/
PRINCE EDWARD ISL.**

- (20) Stan Biggar, 19 Kensington Road,
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FOUNDLAND/
LABRADOR**

- (19) Hugh Scott, 2 Melrose Street, Am-
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- (19) Eastern - Ed Allen, R.R. # 1, Rea-
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- (19) Northeastern - Maurice Lamothe,
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- (19) Northwestern - Carl LeBlanc, Box
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- (20) Western - Gil Wiggins, R.R. # 3,
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- (20) Southwestern (French) - Henri Cho-
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- (19) Northeast - Earl Paquette, 611 Rue
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- (20) Karl Forbes, 2417 Clarence Avenue,
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